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Prepared By: Daisuke Sasatani

Approved By: Craig Elliott

Report Highlights:

Japan's oilseeds and products markets remain stable. Despite high prices, palm oil imports are consistent based on steady demand. Inflationary pressures eased for a period, encouraging crushers to increase soybean crushing while also maintaining rapeseed processing. However, with vegetable oil prices expected to rise in combination with canola crush margins outperforming soybeans, crushers will prioritize rapeseed over soybean crushing. Increased use of Canadian canola has boosted meal production, creating a meal surplus that may dampen rapeseed imports. Despite ample, global soybean meal availability, Japan will maintain stable soybean import levels as protein supplies are robust. Following earlier fish mortality, feed demand for aquaculture softened in 2025 but expected to recover. With domestic fishmeal output likely to fall, fishmeal imports are expected to rise. Elevated 2025 rice prices reduced soybean plantings, but an anticipated rice price decline should support a 2026 rebound in soybean production.

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Oilseeds

Commodities:

Oilseeds, Soybean

Oilseeds, Rapeseed

Oilseeds, Cottonseed

Production, Supply, and Distribution of Soybean (Oilseed)

Oilseed, Soybean	MY 2024/2025		MY 2025/2026		MY 2026/2027	
Market Year Begins	Oct 2024		Oct 2025		Oct 2026	
Japan	USDA Official	New Post	USDA Official	New Post	USDA Official	New Post
Area Planted (1000 HA)	158	154	158	141	0	150
Area Harvested (1000 HA)	154	154	155	141	0	150
Beginning Stocks (1000 MT)	165	165	201	161	0	260
Production (1000 MT)	273	252	250	239	0	245
MY Imports (1000 MT)	3,243	3,243	3,100	3,300	0	3,065
Total Supply (1000 MT)	3,681	3,660	3,551	3,700	0	3,570
MY Exports (1000 MT)	0	0	0	0	0	0
Crush (1000 MT)	2,485	2,512	2,350	2,450	0	2,400
Food Use Dom. Cons. (1000 MT)	900	900	900	900	0	900
Feed Waste Dom. Cons. (1000 MT)	95	87	100	90	0	90
Total Dom. Cons. (1000 MT)	3,480	3,499	3,350	3,440	0	3,390
Ending Stocks (1000 MT)	201	161	201	260	0	180
Total Distribution (1000 MT)	3,681	3,660	3,551	3,700	0	3,570
Yield (MT/HA)	1.773	1.636	1.613	1.695	0	1.633
(1000 HA), (1000 MT), (MT/HA)						
OFFICIAL DATA CAN BE ACCESSED AT: PSD Online Advanced Query						

Production, Supply, and Distribution of Rapeseed (Oilseed)

Oilseed, Rapeseed	MY 2024/2025		MY 2025/2026		MY 2026/2027	
Market Year Begins	Oct 2024		Oct 2025		Oct 2026	
Japan	USDA Official	New Post	USDA Official	New Post	USDA Official	New Post
Area Planted (1000 HA)	2	1.7	2	1.6	0	2
Area Harvested (1000 HA)	2	1.7	2	1.6	0	2
Beginning Stocks (1000 MT)	187	187	173	194	0	226
Production (1000 MT)	3	3.1	4	2.5	0	3
MY Imports (1000 MT)	2,138	2,138	2,400	2,158	0	2,152
Total Supply (1000 MT)	2,328	2,328	2,577	2,355	0	2,355
MY Exports (1000 MT)	0	0	0	0	0	0
Crush (1000 MT)	2,150	2,129	2,370	2,150	0	2,150
Food Use Dom. Cons. (1000 MT)	0	0	0	0	0	0
Feed Waste Dom. Cons. (1000 MT)	5	5	5	5	0	5
Total Dom. Cons. (1000 MT)	2,155	2,134	2,375	2,155	0	2,155
Ending Stocks (1000 MT)	173	194	202	200	0	200
Total Distribution (1000 MT)	2,328	2,328	2,577	2,355	0	2,355
Yield (MT/HA)	1.5	1.87	2	1.60	0	1.5
(1000 HA), (1000 MT), (MT/HA)						
OFFICIAL DATA CAN BE ACCESSED AT: PSD Online Advanced Query						

Production, Supply, and Distribution of Cottonseed (Oilseed)

Oilseed, Cottonseed Market Year Begins Japan	MY 2024/2025		MY 2025/2026		MY 2026/2027	
	Oct 2024		Oct 2025		Oct 2026	
	USDA Official	New Post	USDA Official	New Post	USDA Official	New Post
Area Planted (Cotton) (1000 HA)	0	0	0	0	0	0
Beginning Stocks (1000 MT)	2	2	2	2	0	3
Production (1000 MT)	0	0	0	0	0	0
MY Imports (1000 MT)	100	93	100	98	0	97
Total Supply (1000 MT)	102	95	102	100	0	100
MY Exports (1000 MT)	0	0	0	0	0	0
Crush (1000 MT)	25	23	25	25	0	25
Food Use Dom. Cons. (1000 MT)	0	0	0	0	0	0
Feed Waste Dom. Cons. (1000 MT)	75	70	75	72	0	72
Total Dom. Cons. (1000 MT)	100	93	100	97	0	97
Ending Stocks (1000 MT)	2	2	2	3	0	3
Total Distribution (1000 MT)	102	95	102	100	0	100

(1000 HA), (RATIO), (1000 MT), (MT/HA)

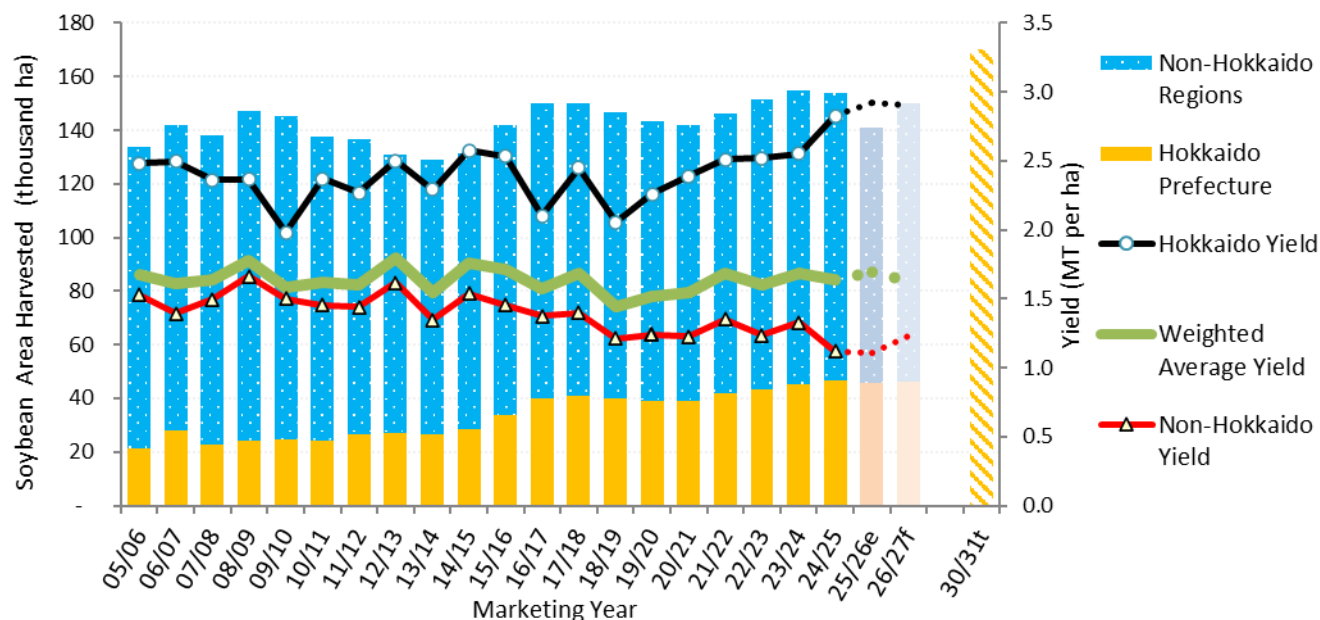
OFFICIAL DATA CAN BE ACCESSED AT: [PSD Online Advanced Query](#)

Production

Soybean

Japan's Ministry of Agriculture, Forestry and Fisheries (MAFF) [officially reported](#) that the soybean production area for marketing year (MY: October to September) 2024/25 was 153,900 hectares (ha), with a total production of 252,400 metric tons (MT), resulting in an average yield of 0.164 MT/ha. The official yield for MY 2024/25 was unexpectedly lower than the [November 2024 estimate released](#) by the National Federation of Agricultural Co-operative Associations (Zen-noh).

Figure 1. Japan Soybean Planting Area and Yield Trends



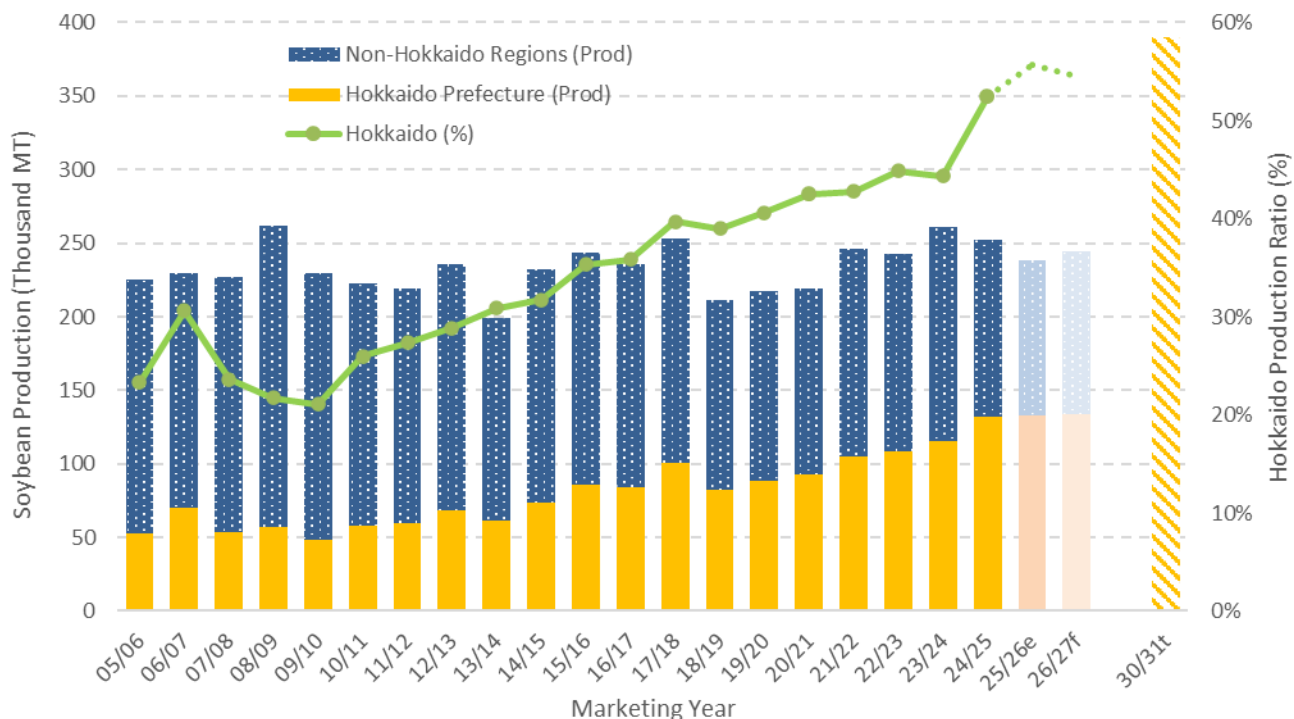
Source: [MAFF](#)

Note: MY 2025/26e represents FAS/Tokyo's forecasts based on [Zen-noh data](#). MY 2026/27f represents FAS/Tokyo's forecasts. MY 2030/31t represents MAFF's target for 2030.

For MY 2025/26, FAS/Tokyo estimates that Japan's soybean production area has decreased to 141,000 ha, based on [Zen-noh's production and sales estimates](#). This eight percent annual decline is attributed to two main factors. Firstly, domestic food-grade soybean prices stagnated in 2024 due to surplus supply. Secondly, and more significantly, farmers prioritized table rice production on paddy land in response to rice shortages and rising prices. [MAFF](#) estimates that soybean plantings on paddies were reduced by about 10,000 ha. As shown in Figure 1, the MY 2025/26 planting area dropped sharply from the long-term trend. However, this is expected to be a short-term adjustment, with the soybean planting area likely to return to the normal trend as table rice prices stabilize. Thus, FAS/Tokyo forecasts that the soybean production area will rebound to around 150,000 ha for MY 2026/27.

Soybean production in Japan is focused on non-genetically engineered (non-GE) food grade varieties, with approximately 80 percent distributed via Japan Agricultural Cooperatives (JA) to food manufacturers for tofu, *natto*, and miso production (see [JA2021-0040](#)). The remaining domestically produced soybeans are typically sold for household use or to small businesses, with limited off-grade soybeans used as on-farm feed. Domestically produced soybeans account for about 30 percent of Japan's food soybean market. MAFF has set a target to increase the production area to 170,000 ha by 2030, and yields have generally improved year by year, especially in Hokkaido, where soybeans are grown on dry fields rather than wet paddies. Additionally, MAFF has supported rice farmers in planting alternative crops, including soybeans, to reduce the rice planting acreage. However, due to recent rice shortages, farmers have increased table rice production and reduced soybean plantings during calendar year 2025 (see [JA2026-0011](#)).

Figure 2. Japan Trends in Soybean Production



Source: [MAFF](#)

Note: MY 2025/26e represents FAS/Tokyo's estimate based on [Zen-noh statistics](#). MY 2026/27f represents FAS/Tokyo's forecasts assuming five-year average yield. MY 2030/31t represents MAFF's target for 2030.

FAS/Tokyo estimates soybean production at 239,000 MT for MY 2025/26, a 5.2 percent decrease from the previous marketing year (Figure 2). Although the planting area declined by 8 percent, yields remained strong, particularly in Hokkaido prefecture. Hokkaido prefecture experienced hot and dry conditions in 2025 early to mid-summer, but benefited from consistent rainfall after August, resulting in another record-breaking soybean yield. Experts note that Hokkaido farmers have proactively adopted high-yield food soybean varieties. In contrast, yields in other parts of Japan were poor for the second consecutive year due to high temperatures and limited precipitation during the summer.

Assuming the five-year average yield of 1.63 MT/ha, FAS/Tokyo forecasts production could reach 245,000 MT in MY 2026/27.

Rapeseed

Japan's limited rapeseed production is concentrated in the Tokachi and Okhotsk regions of Hokkaido, where it is grown as a minor rotation crop. According to [MAFF](#), the harvested area for rapeseed in MY 2025/26 was 1,590 ha¹, a 5 percent decrease from MY 2024/25. Production totaled 2,540 MT, a 19 percent decline from the previous year, due to high temperatures and dry conditions during the flowering-to-ripening period. FAS/Tokyo forecasts that both the harvested area and production volume for rapeseed will remain stable for MY 2026/27.

Cottonseed

Japan does not produce cottonseed.

Consumption

Crush

Soybeans and Rapeseed

In MY 2025/26, FAS/Tokyo forecasts that Japan will marginally increase the rapeseed crush to 2.15 MMT, representing a 1.0 percent increase from the previous year. Conversely, soybean crushing is projected to decrease to 2.45 MMT, representing a 2.5 percent decline. For MY 2026/27, FAS/Tokyo anticipates a further slight reduction in soybean crushing to 2.40 MMT, while rapeseed crushing is expected to remain steady at 2.15 MMT, tracking market condition occurring in spring 2026.

According to [official data](#) from MAFF, oil crushers increased the soybean crush to 2.512 MMT in MY 2024/25, a 5.6 percent rise compared to the previous year. Rapeseed crushing was largely unchanged at 2.129 MMT, as soybean crush margins outperformed those for canola. Table 1 provides a comparison of annual crush volume of soybeans and rapeseeds.

Three major crushers—Nisshin Oillio, J-Oil Mills, and Showa Sangyo—account for over 80 percent of Japan's vegetable oil production, relying primarily on imported U.S. and Brazilian soybeans, in addition to Canadian and Australian canola seeds. These companies are primarily responsible for ensuring a stable and uninterrupted supply of vegetable oils to Japanese consumers. In collaboration with Japanese trading houses, the crushers adjust the ratio of soybeans to canola processed, adjusting opportunistically to changes in relative crush margins (see Figure 3).

¹ This figure does not include ornamental planting areas.

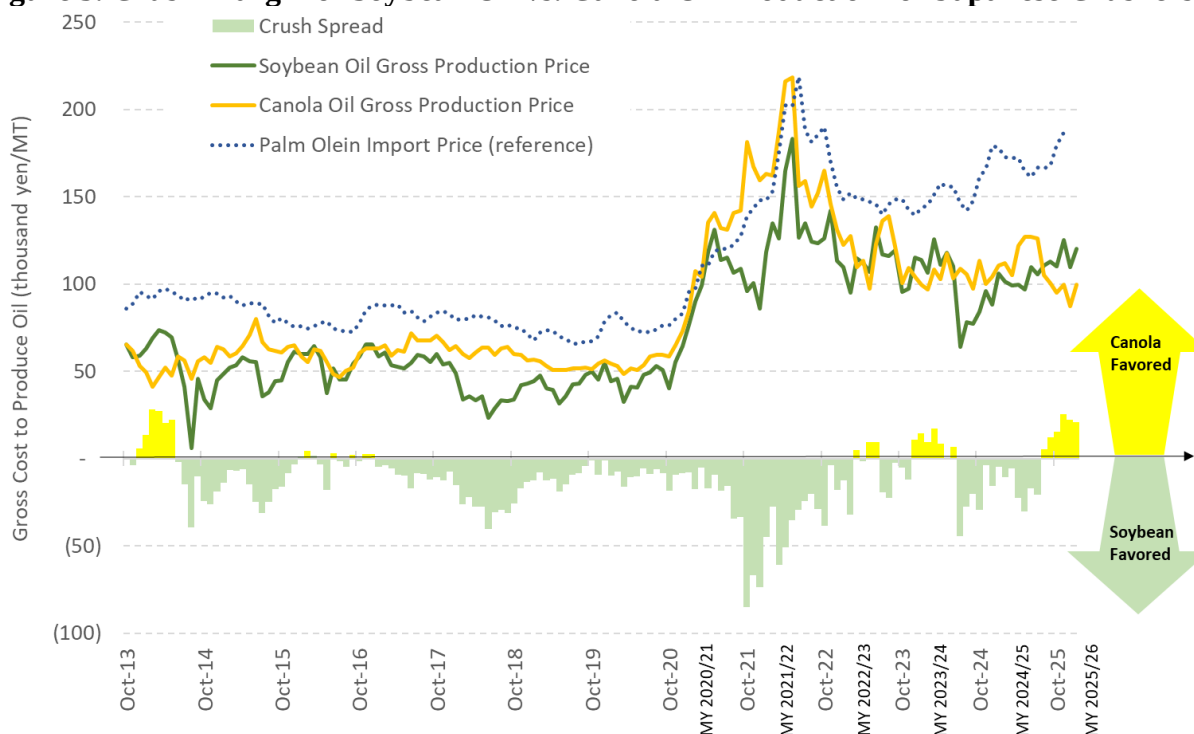
Table 1. Japan Conversion Rate of Oilseeds into Oil (unit: MMT)

	Soybean Oil Crush			Rapeseed Oil Crush			Subtotal Oil Production
	Soybeans	Production	Extr. Rate	Rapeseeds	Production	Extr. Rate	
MY 2018/19	2.470	0.485	0.196	2.396	1.024	0.428	1.509
MY 2019/20	2.393	0.467	0.195	2.270	0.979	0.431	1.446
MY 2020/21	2.364	0.462	0.195	2.357	1.007	0.427	1.469
MY 2021/22	2.600 (+10.0%)	0.519 (+12.3%)	0.200	2.144 (-9.0%)	0.904 (-10.2%)	0.422	1.423 (-3.1%)
MY 2022/23	2.578 (-0.8%)	0.518 (-0.2%)	0.201	1.975 (-7.9%)	0.845 (-6.5%)	0.428	1.363 (-4.2%)
MY 2023/24	2.378 (-7.8%)	0.479 (-7.5%)	0.201	2.116 (+7.1%)	0.920 (+8.9%)	0.435	1.399 (+2.6%)
MY 2024/25	2.512 (+5.6%)	0.507 +5.8%	0.202	2.129 (+0.6%)	0.884 (-3.9%)	0.415	1.391 (-0.6%)
MY 2025/26f	2.450 (-2.5%)	0.490 (-3.4%)	0.200	2.150 (+1.0%)	0.903 (+2.1%)	0.420	1.393 (+0.1%)
MY 2026/27f	2.400	0.480	0.200	2.150	0.903	0.420	1.383

Source: MAFF

Note: “f” represents FAS/Tokyo’s forecasts. FAS/Tokyo’s forecasts of MY 2025/26f include MAFF’s official data from October 2025 to January 2026. The (percentage) amounts are the annual changes from the previous MYs.

Figure 3. Crush Margin of Soybean Oil vs. Canola Oil Production for Japanese Crushers



Sources: Chicago Board of Trade, the Intercontinental Exchange, Federal Reserve Bank of St. Louis

Note: Gross production prices represent the difference between the oilseed and the meal future prices. The production cost does not include operation costs, so it is not advised to compare directly to palm olein import price.

As of spring 2026, the canola crush margin, when converted to Japanese yen, has reached levels not seen since MY 2013/14 (see Figure 3). This margin improvement is attributed to a sharp decline in canola prices beginning from autumn 2025. Industry experts cite several contributing factors, including increased global rapeseed production and ongoing international trade disputes between the United States and Canada, as well as between Canada and China.

FAS/Tokyo anticipates that Japanese oil crushers will cautiously capitalize on the favorable market conditions by increasing the canola crush, primarily using Canadian canola. However, crushers must sell all produced canola meal to maintain profitability. Canadian canola yields a higher proportion of canola meal compared to Australian canola, and Japanese crushers have faced challenges selling canola meal at the start of MY 2025/26. Japanese livestock producers are reluctant to make significant changes to feed formulations, making canola meal inventory a bottleneck for canola oil production. Despite this, the higher profitability of canola crushing compared to soybeans is expected to incentivize crushers to increase the canola crush at the expense of the soybean crush in the latter half of MY 2025/26.

Meanwhile, overall vegetable oil demand in Japan—the primary driver of the oilseeds market—remains stagnant. Further analysis is provided in the “Oils” section of this report. With Nisshin Oillio and J-Oil Mills announcing price increases of 7 to 14 percent from April 1, 2026, FAS/Tokyo projects a reduction in Japanese vegetable oil demand in the second half of MY 2025/26. Nevertheless, domestically produced canola and soybean oils are expected to remain relatively price competitive compared to imported oils, such as palm olein and olive oil. As a result, canola and soybean oils are projected to marginally increase their market share over the next two marketing years.

Cottonseed

According to the [MAFF](#), Japan crushed 22,745 MT of cottonseed in MY 2024/25, a 5.9 percent decrease from the previous year. This yielded 4,045 MT of cottonseed oil, with an oil extraction rate of 0.178. Okamura Oil Mill in Osaka remains the sole cottonseed crusher in Japan. A month-long planned maintenance at the facility in May 2025 contributed to the decline in cottonseed consumption during the year. Cottonseed oil is primarily used as a premium frying oil (e.g., for *tempura* and boutique donuts) and as a high-end oil for canned fish. Cottonseed meal production totaled 11,161 MT in MY 2024/25, with most used as fertilizer for tea and fruit trees and as feed for dairy cows. FAS/Tokyo projects that the cottonseed crush will return to the typical level of 25,000 MT for both MY 2025/26 and MY 2026/27, as Japan’s cottonseed oil production remains stable.

Food Use Consumption

FAS/Tokyo forecasts that the food use consumption of soybeans will remain at 900,000 MT in MY 2025/26 and MY 2026/27. Japan is expected to fully utilize domestically produced soybeans for food use, with fluctuations in consumption reflecting changes in domestic production.

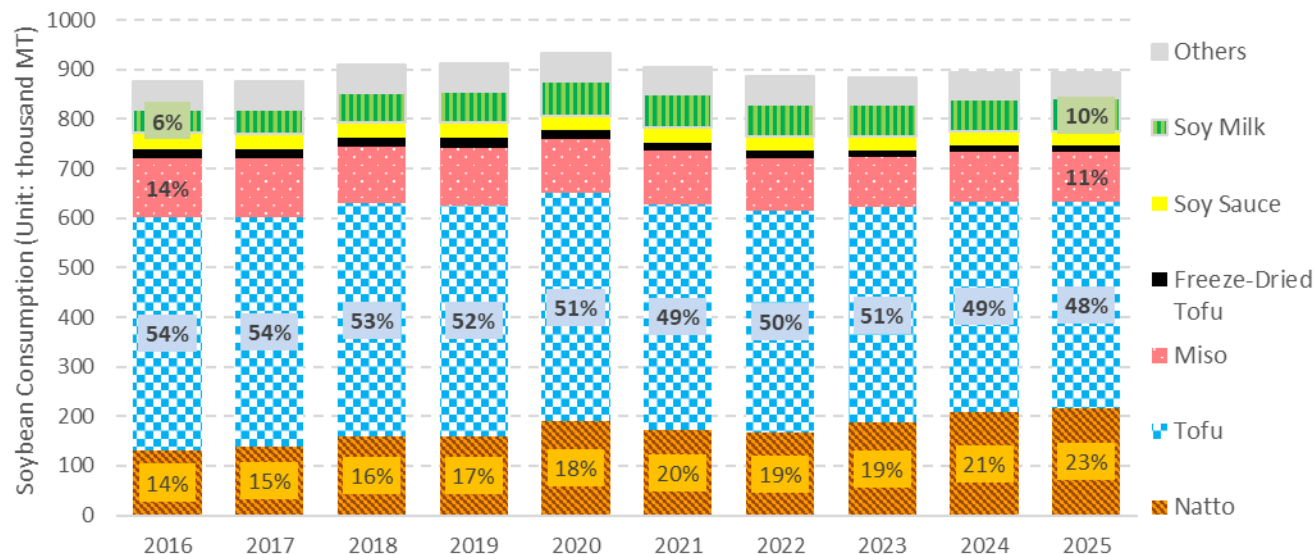
Processed soy food manufacturers—including tofu, *natto*, miso, soymilk, and simmered soybeans—account for the majority of food-grade soybean use in Japan. The market for these products is mature and largely saturated, with food soybean consumption remaining around 0.9 MMT over the past decade.

According to “The Daily Soybean Oil” publication, soy food use is projected to be 894,300 MT in 2025. In the past decade, tofu and miso production has declined. In 2016, 54 percent and 14 percent of food-grade soybeans were used to produce tofu and miso, respectively, but the share has dropped to 48

percent and 11 percent in 2025. On the other hand, food-grade soybeans for producing *natto* increased from 14 percent in 2016 to 23 percent in 2025 (Figure 4). It's important to note that a number of consumers appreciate the nutritional value of *natto* (fermented soybeans); however, many people also appreciate the affordability and convenience. The ease of preparing *natto* makes it a staple for quick breakfasts or as an easy side dish. The number of single-person households across a variety of age ranges has increased, leading to increased *natto* consumption. The share of soymilk also increased from 6 percent in 2016 to 10 percent in 2025. Nutritional value is one reason why people purchase soymilk, but also the number of immigrants from East and Southeast Asian countries to Japan has grown, increasing the consumption of soymilk as a preferred beverage.

The domestic demand for processed soy foods is stagnant due to Japan's declining population. Due to the perception of processed soy products as affordable staple foods, it is challenging for manufacturers to raise retail prices. In contrast and with the advantage of the weak yen, exports of these processed soy products have increased, offsetting the shrinking domestic market.

Figure 4. Food-Grade Soybean Consumption by Type of Processed Food



Source: The Daily Soybean Oil

Feed, Seed, and Waste Consumption

Soybeans and Rapeseed

FAS/Tokyo estimates that total soybean feed, seed and waste consumption—including feed use by millers, seed, waste, and local on-farm feed—was 87,000 MT in MY 2024/25. This level is projected to remain unchanged for both MY 2025/26 and MY 2026/27, as protein feed ingredients are abundant and there is no incentive for feed manufacturers to increase soybean inclusion in compound feed.

According to [MAFF feed statistics](#), feed manufacturers' soybean consumption was stable at 75,087 MT in MY 2024/25. The abundance and low cost of soybean meal continues to impede the increased use of whole soybeans in feed. Some domestically produced off-grade soybeans are used for on-farm feed, but these volumes are not captured in the official statistics.

Soybean seeds in Japan are used not only for soybean production but also for edamame and bean sprout cultivation. Edamame, harvested while still green and tender, is produced mainly by small-scale farmers

located in prefectures near major cities (e.g. Niigata, Gunma, and Tochigi), and benefit from efficient short-term returns. Japan plants soybeans on approximately 12,000 hectares of edamame farmland, producing around 60,000 MT of edamame annually. Farmers utilize various sweeter soybean varieties, such as *Yuagari-Musume* and *Dada-Chamame*. Since MAFF classifies edamame as a vegetable rather than an oilseed, these production areas are not included in the soybean PSD table.

Rapeseed feed, seed and waste consumption remains minimal.

Cottonseed

FAS/Tokyo projects cottonseed feed consumption will remain steady at 72,000 MT in both MY 2025/26 and MY 2026/27, as Japan's dairy production stabilizes and cottonseed supply returns to normal. Feed manufacturers use cottonseed as a minor ingredient for dairy cow rations to boost milk fat. For further details, see the [Japan Dairy and Products Annual](#).

Trade

Japan relies almost entirely on oilseed imports, with no tariffs on soybeans, rapeseed, or cottonseed.

Soybeans

FAS/Tokyo forecasts that Japan will import 3.30 MMT of soybeans in MY 2025/26, reducing to 3.07 MMT for MY 2026/27 as the canola crush sees increases.

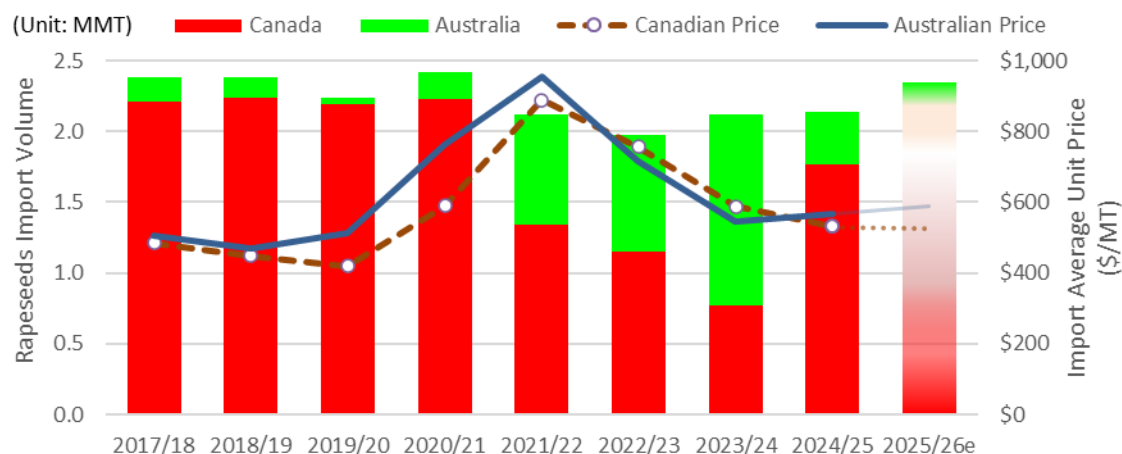
In MY 2024/25, Japan imported 3.243 MMT of soybeans, a 4.6 percent increase from the previous year. Typically, about 80 percent of imports are feed-grade and 20 percent are food-grade. The United States remained the leading supplier of both feed-grade and food-grade soybeans, accounting for 65.9 percent of total soybean imports. Brazil supplied 22.8 percent, primarily feed-grade soybeans. Japanese crushers prefer U.S. soybeans for oil quality, but the industry's requirement for 47.5 percent crude protein in soybean meal for high-protein feed (Hi-Pro) sustains Brazil's market share due to the higher protein content in Brazilian soybeans.

Japanese food manufacturers often use North American "identity preserved" (IP) soybeans to supply price-sensitive mass markets. Canada focuses on food-grade soybeans and supplied 10.8 percent of soybeans in MY 2024/25, ranking as the third largest exporter to Japan. Japanese buyers pay a premium to ensure North American farmers grow lower-yield, food-grade varieties. Conversely, domestic soybeans are used for high-end products, with manufacturers emphasizing the use of domestically grown soybeans for premium offerings. Since MY 2024/25, North American food-grade soybean prices have sometimes exceeded prices for Japan-grown soybeans, leading to softer purchasing interest due to high inventory levels. Experts expect inventory levels to normalize and the food-grade soybean market to recover, as Japan reduced soybean production in MY 2025/26.

Rapeseed

FAS/Tokyo forecasts Japanese rapeseed imports at 2.158 MMT in MY 2025/26 and 2.152 MMT in MY 2026/27, as the canola oil crush remains robust. Japan imports canola seeds primarily from Canada and Australia to meet the country's crushing demand.

Figure 5. Japan's Rapeseed Imports by Origin



Source: Japan Customs

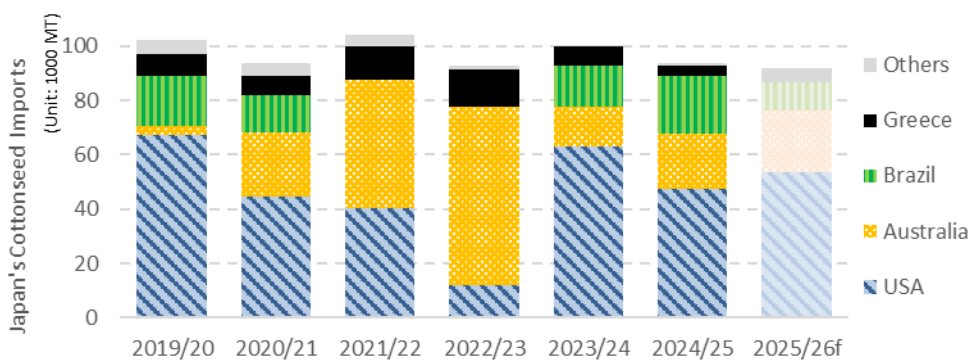
Note: MY 2025/26e estimates are the year-to-date estimates.

In MY 2024/25, rapeseed imports increased to 2.138 MMT. Historically, Canada supplied 95 to 97 percent of Japan's rapeseed imports (Figure 5). However, since MY 2021/22, Japan increased purchases of Australian canola seeds due to poor Canadian crops and robust Australian harvests. Japanese crushers have noted higher oil extraction rates from Australian canola compared to Canadian seeds, though meal extraction rates are converse. In MY 2023/24, Australia became the leading rapeseed supplier to Japan for the first time. Canada's share recovered to 82.9 percent in MY 2024/25, but Japanese crushers continue to source canola seeds from both countries to diversify supply.

Cottonseed

FAS/Tokyo projects Japanese cottonseed imports will increase to 98,000 metric tons (MT) in MY 2025/26 and to 97,000 MT in MY 2026/27, reflecting stable feed demand from the dairy industry and consistent utilization by oil crushers.

Figure 6. Japan's Cottonseed Imports by Origin



Source: Japan Customs

Note: MY 2025/26f estimates are the year-to-date estimates.

Genetically engineered (GE) cottonseed must receive regulatory approval for food and feed use in Japan (see the [Japan Agricultural Biotechnology Annual](#) for details on regulations). As a result, only select countries are eligible to supply cottonseed to the Japanese market. In MY 2024/25, Japan imported

93,450 MT of cottonseed. The United States accounted for 50.5 percent of imports, followed by Brazil (22.5 percent), Australia (21.9 percent), and Greece (4.5 percent) (Figure 6). In general, oil crushers prefer cottonseed with higher oil content and primarily select Brazilian and Greek cottonseed. In contrast, feed millers favor U.S. and Australian cottonseed for feed use.

Stocks

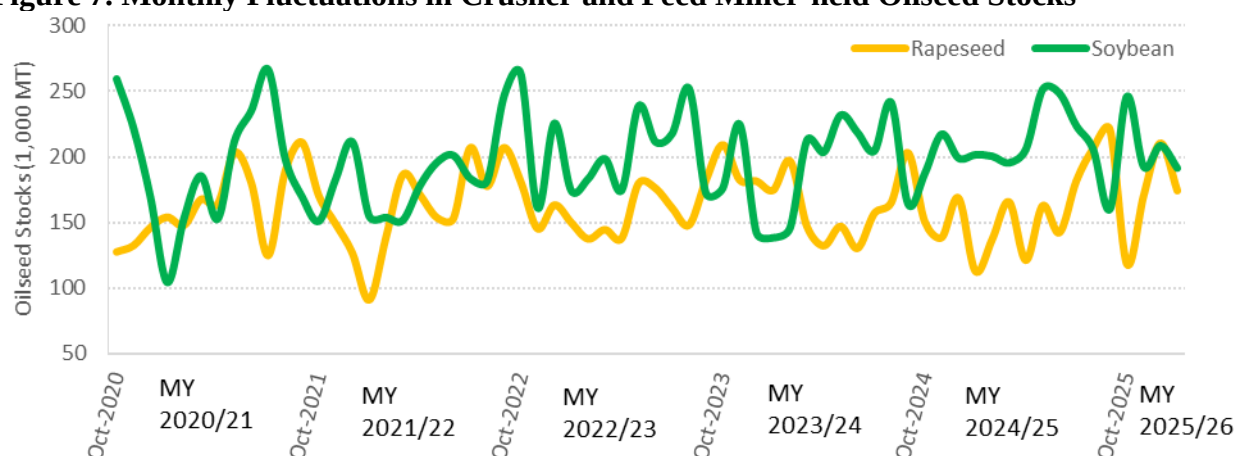
Oilseed, meal, and oil stocks in Japan are held by private sector entities for business operations. There is no national stockpiling system for soybeans, rapeseeds, or cottonseeds. To help private businesses respond to rapid changes in international food trade and ensure stable soybean imports, the government supports storage costs incurred when switching the country of origin for soybean imports. In FY 2025, the Ministry of Agriculture, Forestry and Fisheries (MAFF) allocated 2.2 billion yen in the supplementary budget under the "Emergency Measure to Establish a Stable Food Import System."

FAS/Tokyo forecasts that soybean ending stocks will rise to 260,000 MT in MY 2025/26, up from 160,578 MT at the end of MY 2024/25, as oil crushers take full advantage of the Emergency Measure. However, this support is temporary, and FAS/Tokyo projects that soybean stocks will decrease to 180,000 MT by the end of MY 2026/27.

Rapeseed ending stocks are forecast to remain stable at around 200,000 MT in both MY 2025/26 and MY 2026/27, as Japan continues to utilize high levels of canola seeds for crushing. MAFF reported rapeseed stocks of 203,008 MT at the end of MY 2023/24 and 220,378 MT at the end of MY 2024/25².

Cottonseed ending stocks are expected to hover around 3,000 MT in both MY 2024/25 and MY 2025/26. MAFF reported beginning stocks for cottonseed crush at 1,512 MT in MY 2025/26. There are no official figures for cottonseed stocks used in feed, but FAS/Tokyo estimates total cottonseed stocks at 3,000 MT.

Figure 7. Monthly Fluctuations in Crusher and Feed Miller-held Oilseed Stocks



Source: MAFF

² PSD stocks figures in MY 2024/25 are adjusted due to measurement errors.

Meals

Commodities:

Meal, Soybean
Meal, Rapeseed
Meal, Fish
Meal, Palm Kernel

Production, Supply, and Distribution of Soybean Meal

Meal, Soybean Market Year Begins Japan	MY 2024/2025		MY 2025/2026		MY 2026/2027	
	Oct 2024		Oct 2025		Oct 2026	
	USDA Official	New Post	USDA Official	New Post	USDA Official	New Post
Crush (1000 MT)	2,485	2,512	2,350	2,450	0	2,400
Extr. Rate, 999.9999 (PERCENT)	0.750	0.753	0.751	0.751	0	0.751
Beginning Stocks (1000 MT)	112	112	116	119	0	120
Production (1000 MT)	1,864	1,892	1,765	1,840	0	1,802
MY Imports (1000 MT)	1,621	1,621	1,700	1,660	0	1,700
Total Supply (1000 MT)	3,597	3,625	3,581	3,619	0	3,622
MY Exports (1000 MT)	1	1	1	1	0	1
Industrial Dom. Cons. (1000 MT)	200	200	210	200	0	200
Food Use Dom. Cons. (1000 MT)	200	200	200	200	0	200
Feed Waste Dom. Cons. (1000 MT)	3,080	3,105	3,050	3,098	0	3,101
Total Dom. Cons. (1000 MT)	3,480	3,505	3,460	3,498	0	3,501
Ending Stocks (1000 MT)	116	119	120	120	0	120
Total Distribution (1000 MT)	3,597	3,625	3,581	3,619	0	3,622
(1000 MT) ,(PERCENT)						
OFFICIAL DATA CAN BE ACCESSED AT: PSD Online Advanced Query						

Production, Supply, and Distribution of Rapeseed Meal

Meal, Rapeseed Market Year Begins Japan	MY 2024/2025		MY 2025/2026		MY 2026/2027	
	Oct 2024		Oct 2025		Oct 2026	
	USDA Official	New Post	USDA Official	New Post	USDA Official	New Post
Crush (1000 MT)	2,150	2,129	2,370	2,150	0	2,150
Extr. Rate, 999.9999 (PERCENT)	0.565	0.578	0.565	0.572	0	0.572
Beginning Stocks (1000 MT)	83	83	64	89	0	95
Production (1000 MT)	1,215	1,231	1,338	1,230	0	1,230
MY Imports (1000 MT)	4	4	6	5	0	5
Total Supply (1000 MT)	1,302	1,318	1,408	1,324	0	1,330
MY Exports (1000 MT)	8	8	0	0	0	0
Industrial Dom. Cons. (1000 MT)	100	100	110	100	0	100
Food Use Dom. Cons. (1000 MT)	0	0	0	0	0	0
Feed Waste Dom. Cons. (1000 MT)	1,130	1,121	1,220	1,129	0	1,130
Total Dom. Cons. (1000 MT)	1,230	1,221	1,330	1,229	0	1,230
Ending Stocks (1000 MT)	64	89	78	95	0	100
Total Distribution (1000 MT)	1,302	1,318	1,408	1,324	0	1,330
(1000 MT) ,(PERCENT)						
OFFICIAL DATA CAN BE ACCESSED AT: PSD Online Advanced Query						

Production, Supply, and Distribution of Fishmeal

Meal, Fish	2024/2025 (CY 2025)		2025/2026 (CY 2026)		2026/2027 (CY 2027)	
Market Year Begins	Jan 2025		Jan 2026		Jan 2027	
Japan	USDA Official	New Post	USDA Official	New Post	USDA Official	New Post
Catch For Reduction (1000 MT)	950	769	950	755	0	750
Extr. Rate, 999.9999 (PERCENT)	0.211	0.217	0.211	0.217	0	0.216
Beginning Stocks (1000 MT)	23	23	18	16	0	15
Production (1000 MT)	200	167	200	164	0	162
MY Imports (1000 MT)	138	132	135	155	0	158
Total Supply (1000 MT)	361	322	353	335	0	335
MY Exports (1000 MT)	8	7	5	7	0	7
Industrial Dom. Cons. (1000 MT)	65	40	65	43	0	43
Food Use Dom. Cons. (1000 MT)	0	0	0	0	0	0
Feed Waste Dom. Cons. (1000 MT)	270	259	265	270	0	270
Total Dom. Cons. (1000 MT)	335	299	330	313	0	313
Ending Stocks (1000 MT)	18	16	18	15	0	15
Total Distribution (1000 MT)	361	322	353	335	0	335
(1000 MT) ,(PERCENT)						
OFFICIAL DATA CAN BE ACCESSED AT: PSD Online Advanced Query						

Note: Fishmeal PSD figures do not include crustacean meal.

Production, Supply, and Distribution of Palm Residues (HS Code: 2306.60)

Meal, Palm Kernel	MY 2024/2025		MY 2025/2026		MY 2026/2027	
Market Year Begins	Oct 2024		Oct 2025		Oct 2026	
Japan	USDA Official	New Post	USDA Official	New Post	USDA Official	New Post
Crush (1000 MT)	0	0	0	0	0	0
Beginning Stocks (1000 MT)	0	0	0	0	0	0
Production (1000 MT)	0	0	0	0	0	0
MY Imports (1000 MT)	80	77	130	75	0	75
Total Supply (1000 MT)	80	77	130	75	0	75
MY Exports (1000 MT)	0	0	0	0	0	0
Industrial Dom. Cons. (1000 MT)	76	73	126	71	0	71
Food Use Dom. Cons. (1000 MT)	0	0	0	0	0	0
Feed Waste Dom. Cons. (1000 MT)	4	4	4	4	0	4
Total Dom. Cons. (1000 MT)	80	77	130	75	0	75
Ending Stocks (1000 MT)	0	0	0	0	0	0
Total Distribution (1000 MT)	80	77	130	75	0	75
(1000 MT) ,(PERCENT)						
OFFICIAL DATA CAN BE ACCESSED AT: PSD Online Advanced Query						

Note: Due to the difference in the application of HS codes used by Japan and its palm kernel residue suppliers (Malaysia and Indonesia), Malaysia's and Indonesia's export data differ notably from Japan's import data (see [JA2020-0110](#)). FAS/Tokyo relies on suppliers' export data to capture Japanese palm kernel residue imports, which are primarily utilized as biomass by Japanese powerplants. Above numbers do not represent the total PKS consumption by Japanese power plants (see [JA2023-0071](#)).

Production

Soybean and Rapeseed Meal

As referenced in the “Oilseed Consumption” section, FAS/Tokyo forecasts a rise in rapeseed meal production to 1.23 MMT in MY 2025/26 and also in MY 2026/27, as canola crush margins have become relatively competitive. FAS/Tokyo assumes the rapeseed meal extraction rate will decrease to 0.572 as the oil content of Canadian canola seeds recovers from MY 2024/25.

FAS/Tokyo forecasts that Japan will gradually decrease soybean meal production to 1.84 MMT in MY 2025/26 and to 1.80 MMT for MY 2026/27, assuming the five-year average soybean meal extraction rate of 0.751.

[MAFF](#) reports that soybean meal production in MY 2023/25 was 1.892 MMT (meal extraction rate: 0.753), a 6.3 percent increase from MY 2023/24 due to higher soybean consumption. Rapeseed meal production also increased to 1.231 MMT, a 3.6 percent increase from MY 2023/24. This increase is attributed to a historically high rapeseed meal extraction rate of 0.578 because Japan increased canola seed imports from Canada (see Figure 5 of “Oilseeds” section) and those seeds contained less oil. See Table 2 for detailed information.

Japanese oilseed crushers produce soybean meal and rapeseed meal as by-products, supplying approximately half of domestic soybean meal feed consumption and all of the domestic rapeseed meal feed consumption.

Table 2. Soybean and Rapeseed Meal Production from Domestic Crush (unit: MMT)

	Soybean Meal Production			Rapeseed Meal Production			Subtotal SME
	Soybeans	Production	Extr. Rate	Rapeseeds	Production	Extr. Rate	
MY 2018/19	2.470	1.854	0.751	2.396	1.326	0.554	2.798
MY 2019/20	2.393	1.799	0.752	2.270	1.236	0.545	2.679
MY 2020/21	2.364	1.783	0.754	2.357	1.322	0.561	2.724
MY 2021/22	2.600 (+10.0%)	1.946 (+9.2%)	0.749	2.144 (-9.0%)	1.221 (-7.6%)	0.570	2.815
MY 2022/23	2.578 (-0.8%)	1.937 (-0.5%)	0.751	1.975 (-7.9%)	1.116 (-8.6%)	0.552	2.731
MY 2023/24	2.378 (-7.8%)	1.780 (-8.1%)	0.749	2.116 (+7.1%)	1.188 (+6.5%)	0.561	2.625
MY 2024/25	2.512 (+5.6%)	1.892 (+6.3%)	0.753	2.129 (+0.6%)	1.231 (+3.6%)	0.578	2.768
MY 2025/26^f	2.450 (-2.5%)	1.840 (-2.8%)	0.751	2.150 (+1.0%)	1.230 (-0.1%)	0.572	2.715
MY 2026/27^f	2.400	1.802	0.751	2.150	1.230	0.572	2.677

Source: MAFF

“^f” represents FAS/Tokyo’s forecasts. FAS/Tokyo’s forecasts of MY 2025/26^f include MAFF’s official data from October 2025 to January 2026. The (percentage) amounts are the annual changes from the previous MYs.

Fishmeal

The fishmeal marketing year (FM-MY) 2024/25 runs from January through December 2025 (i.e., the calendar year, CY 2025). Assuming the five-year average extraction rate of 0.217, FAS/Tokyo projects that Japan will produce 164,000 MT of fishmeal from 755,000 MT of domestic inputs in FM-MY 2026.

FAS/Tokyo expects trimmings to remain around 550,000 MT annually as seafood manufacturers continue to reduce their production. Although it is extremely difficult to predict the future size of the sardine catch, FAS/Tokyo assumes that the availability of sardines for fishmeal production will decline to around 200,000 MT, as the [monthly sardine catch](#) shows a downward trend. FAS/Tokyo further projects that Japanese fishmeal production will decline to 162,000 MT in FM-MY 2027 as this declining trend continues (Table 3).

Japan primarily utilizes domestic fish trimmings and small whole fish, primarily Pacific sardines³ (*Sardinops melanostictus*), as inputs for the production of fish oil and fishmeal (see Table 3). As overall seafood prices have risen, the production of processed seafood products in Japan has declined. This decline has reduced the volume of trimmings available for fishmeal and fish oil production over time.

Table 3. Japan's Fishmeal Production and Supply (unit: thousand MT)

	CY	2021	2022	2023	2024	2025	2026 ^f	2027 ^f
	FM-MY	2020/21	2021/22	2022/23	2023/24	2024/25	2025/26	2026/27
Domestic Input	Trimmings	672	620	570	557	555	555	
	Whole Fish	280	231	312	255	213	200	
	Total	952	851	882	812	769	755	750
Domestic Production	Fish Oil	79	67	72	64	62		
	Extr. Rate	8.3%	7.8%	8.1%	7.9%	8.1%		
	Fishmeal	205	187	193	177	167	164	162
	Extr. Rate	21.5%	21.9%	21.8%	21.8%	21.7%	21.7%	21.6%
Fishmeal Imports	Peru	45	40	23	35	32		
	Chile	22	20	22	11	12		
	U.S.	14	8	14	16	17		
	U.S. (%)	9.3%	5.0%	7.9%	9.6%	12.3%		
	Total	146	160	178	171	138	155	158
Total Fishmeal Supply		351	347	371	348	305	319	320
Crustacean Meal Imports		5	5	4	5	6	5	5

Sources: [Japan Marine Oil Association](#) and Japan Customs

Note: Total numbers may not match due to rounding error. "f" indicates FAS/Tokyo's forecasts.

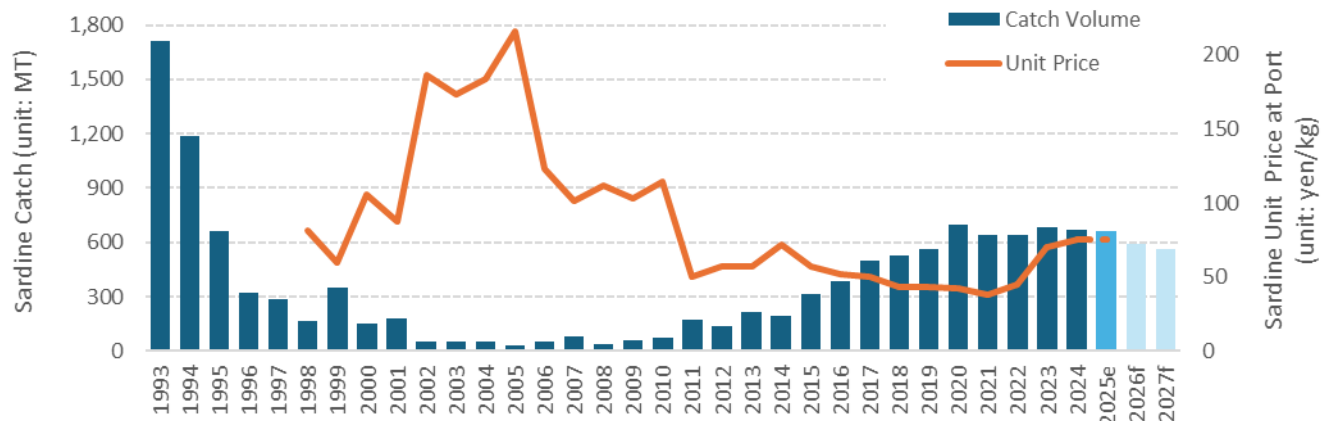
Sardine resources showed signs of recovery until CY 2023 in comparison to the historically poor catches of the early 2000s (see Figure 8). The [Japan Fisheries Agency](#) reported a total sardine catch of 680,900 MT in 2023. However, the catch declined to about 666,403 MT in CY 2024 and further to about 658,000 MT in CY 2025, based on [monthly reports](#).

As the catch of Pacific sardines off the eastern coast of Hokkaido has decreased, fishmeal production volume in Hokkaido has fallen by an additional 10 percent in CY 2025. In addition, sardine schools remained around *Choshi* in Chiba prefecture through autumn 2025. Normally, these schools would have migrated north to Hokkaido by that time, but they stayed in the *Choshi* area for a longer period. As a

³ Also known as Japanese pilchard or *ma-iwashi*.

result, sardine catches in Chiba were strong, while catches in Hokkaido were poor in CY 2025. The sardines caught in *Choshi* tend to be sold directly to the aquaculture industry as frozen whole fish or used for human consumption, rather than for the production of fishmeal and fish oil.

Figure 8. Japan's Sardine Catch and Pricing



Source: [Japan Fisheries Agency](#)

Note: “e” indicates FAS/Tokyo’s estimation from MAFF monthly data and “f” indicates forecasts.

According to preliminary results from the Japan Marine Oil Association, in CY 2025 (FM-MY 2023/24), Japan produced 166,600 MT of fishmeal, a six percent decline from the previous year, in addition to 61,900 MT of fish oil. In CY 2025, domestic fish inputs declined to 768,500 MT, including 213,300 MT of whole fish (such as sardines) and 555,200 MT of trimmings. The fish meal extraction rate marginally declined to 21.7 percent in CY 2025.

Palm Kernel Meal

Japan does not produce palm kernel meal.

Consumption

Feed and Waste Consumption

Soybean Meal and Rapeseed Meal

Accounting for the feed consumption by feed millers as reported in the [official statistics](#), as well as unreported feed consumption and waste, FAS/Tokyo forecasts an increase in rapeseed meal feed and waste consumption to 1.13 MMT in MY 2025/26 and MY 2026/27 as there is full utilization of domestically produced rapeseed meal in Japan. Conversely, FAS/Tokyo forecasts for consistent soybean meal feed consumption of 3.10 MMT in MY 2025/26 and in MY 2026/27, as global soybean meal prices are expected to remain relatively low and supplies abundant, while acknowledging that crushers will also reduce soybean production. It is important to note that MAFF’s [feed statistics](#) do not include on-farm soybean meal feed. However, the feed and waste consumption values in the PSD table include those estimates. In short, the feed demand from the Japanese livestock sector has remained remarkably stable and constant.

Considering the feed consumption by feed millers, in MY 2024/25, [MAFF](#) reported that Japanese livestock and aquaculture consumed 3.015 MMT of soybean meal, a 1.1 percent decrease from the previous MY, and 1.183 MMT of rapeseed meal (approximately 0.794 MMT soybean meal equivalent

(SME)), a 4.9 percent increase from the previous MY. The global prices of feed ingredients, including soybean and rapeseed meals converted into yen, began rising in early 2022, and livestock farmers have attempted to reduce the overall feed volumes while still supplying sufficient protein and energy to the livestock and aquaculture industries.

Table 4. Protein Consumption by Livestock and Aquaculture (unit: thousand MT SME)

	2019/20	2020/21	2021/22	2022/23	2023/24	2024/25	2025/26 ^f	2026/27 ^f
Grand Total	8,600	8,690	8,665	8,507	8,533	8,484	8,500	8,470
of DDGS	251	254	254	250	240	230	222	
of CGF&M	453	450	449	478	504	507	498	
Animal-based protein subtotal	697	770	751	702	696	680	675	
of fishmeal	264	266	264	252	242	222	220	
of slaughterhouse waste	334	393	374	344	360	381	417	
High-protein oil meals subtotal	4,067	4,083	4,061	3,955	3,969	3,969	3,982	3,980
of rapeseed meal (canola meal)	807	818	796	697	756	794	805	805
of soybean meal	3,096	3,097	3,098	3,090	3,049	3,015	3,019	3,010
of palm kernel meal	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
of other meal (sesame etc.)	164	168	167	168	164	160	158	155

Note: “f” indicates forecasts by FAS/Tokyo. FAS/Tokyo’s forecasts of MY 2025/26^f is based on MAFF’s official data from October 2025 to January 2026. Above numbers do not include unreported feed consumption.

Source: MAFF

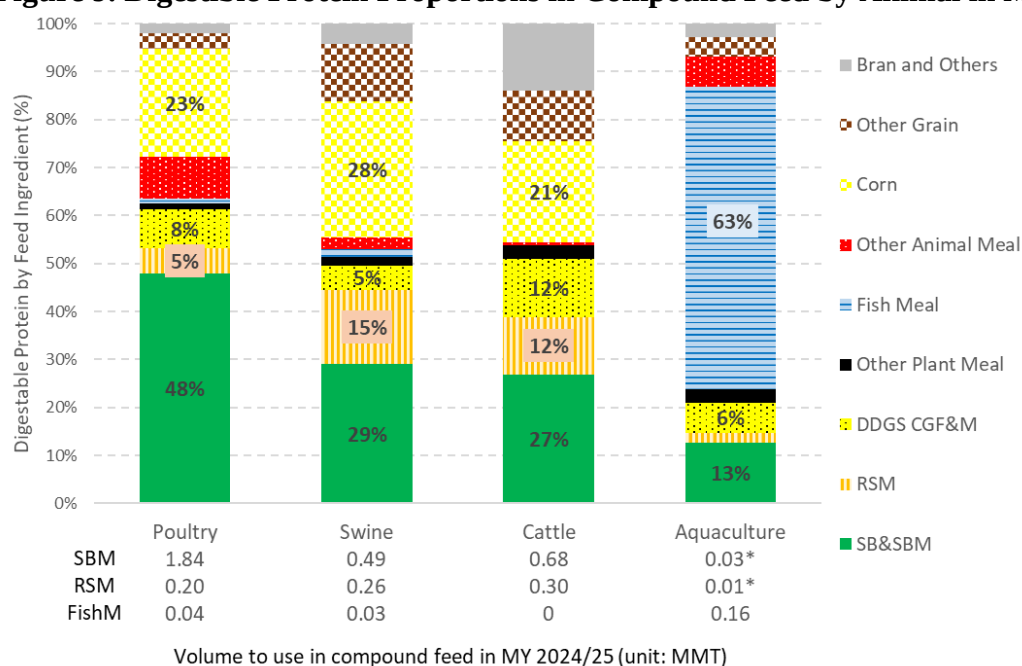
Based on MAFF’s [feed statistics](#), FAS/Tokyo estimates that Japanese feed millers consumed 8.48 MMT of SME protein⁴, a marginal decrease of 0.57 percent from the previous MY (Table 4). SME protein consumption consisted of 35.5 percent soybean meal, 9.4 percent rapeseed meal, 6.0 percent corn gluten feed and meal (CGF&M), 2.7 percent distillers’ dried grains with solubles (DDGS), 4.5 percent slaughterhouse waste (such as meat and bone meal and feather meal), and 2.6 percent fishmeal. Although protein content per volume is lower, SME protein consumption from corn increased to 23.1 percent, while SME protein consumption from other grains, including feed-grade rice, decreased to 6.9 percent in MY 2024/25.

Four major developments were observed in MY 2024/25. Firstly, due to a rice shortage, feed millers significantly increased corn usage and reduced feed rice usage ([JA2026-0011](#)), although protein consumption from total grains remained stable at around 30 percent. Secondly, slaughterhouse waste usage increased while fishmeal consumption decreased. In October 2024, Japan lifted the ban on the use of meat and bone meal derived from ruminant animals in swine and poultry feed. Japan had maintained this ban since 2001 due to concerns over bovine spongiform encephalopathy (BSE). As a result, poultry and swine farmers now have more protein source options. Thirdly, Japan increased the imports of corn gluten feed (CGF) from China as starch demand in China weakened. In MY 2024/25, the protein consumption from CGF reached 0.507 MMT SME, representing 6.0 percent of total protein demand. Consequently, Japan reduced the imports of DDGS and soybean meal (Table 4).

⁴ To facilitate the comparison of crude protein levels across different feeds, they are expressed in soybean meal equivalent (SME): 1 MT of rapeseed meal equals 0.7115 MT SME; of fishmeal is 1.445 MT SME, of soybeans is 0.8 MT SME, of maize is 0.1646 MT SME, of CGF is 0.4080 MT SME, of DDGS is 0.5833 MT SME, of feather meal is 1.702 MT SME, and of meat bone meal is 1.898 MT SME.

Fourthly, rapeseed meal consumption methods have become a key issue. Oil crushers need to sell their domestically produced canola seed meal in the domestic market to generate income. Industry experts report that crushers increased canola meal production but then struggled to sell it to the livestock industry in MY 2024/25. Livestock farmers often add yellow grease (used cooking oil) when feeding canola meal to supplement energy content. However, yellow grease prices have been very high (see the Oils section), which has made farmers reluctant to increase the quantity of rapeseed meal in rations. In addition, abundant CGF supplies have limited the incentive for further canola meal inclusion. Even though Japanese crushers are keen to expand canola oil production given the historically favorable crush margins, they remain cautious about the rapeseed meal market. Japan previously had a higher rapeseed meal share, but industry experts believe that the current canola meal blend rate has reached its ceiling under the present market conditions. For MY 2025/26 and MY 2026/27, this will be a major consideration for Japanese canola crushing.

Figure 9. Digestible Protein Proportions in Compound Feed by Animal in MY 2024/25



Source: MAFF

Note: *denotes FAS/Tokyo estimates of aquaculture meal consumption during MY 2024/25 (2024 October-2025 September).

Import prices of feed ingredients were stable, compound feed prices remained stable until the beginning of MY 2025/26, and feed consumption was also stable. In addition, the egg industry has increased production as it recovers from the highly pathogenic avian influenza (HPAI) outbreak, supporting resilient protein feed demand for layers in early MY 2025/26. However, prices for inputs are expected to rise in the latter half of MY 2025/26, and egg producers are likely to adjust production sooner. Thus, FAS/Tokyo forecasts total SME requirements by the Japanese feed sector will increase marginally to 8.50 MMT in MY 2025/26 and then decrease to 8.47 MMT in MY 2026/27.

Figure 9 provides detailed information on the proportion of digestible protein sources in the diets of farmed animals and aquaculture in MY 2024/25. For more information on the Japanese feed market, see the [2026 Japan Grain and Feed Annual](#), and for more information on the Japanese livestock market, see the [2026 Japan Livestock and Products Semi-annual](#).

Fishmeal

FAS/Tokyo forecasts that fishmeal consumption for livestock and aquaculture feed will recover to 270,000 MT in FM-MY 2025/26 (CY 2026) and FM-MY 2026/27 (CY 2027), rebounding from the decline in fish stocks caused by elevated sea temperatures in summer 2024. FAS/Tokyo estimates that feed-use fishmeal consumption dropped to 259,000 MT in CY 2025. Recently, about 10 percent of fishmeal feed consumption is from the livestock sector, and the remaining 90 percent is from the aquaculture industry.

For livestock feed, fishmeal is currently used as a specialty ingredient for baby swine and poultry to supplement nutrients that other protein feeds do not provide. Eggs produced by layers that are fed fishmeal can be sold at premium prices, so a portion of value-added egg producers prefer to use fishmeal. In CY 2025, MAFF reported that livestock consumed 41,595 MT of fishmeal, a 9.8 percent decline from CY 2024. However, fishmeal consumption by livestock has been steadily decreasing due to its high cost. Feed millers have tried to substitute fishmeal with other protein feeds, especially animal-derived meals. As Japan has lifted the ban on meat and bone meal derived from ruminant animals in October 2024, this substitution trend is expected to continue.

As mentioned, roughly 90 percent of feed-use fishmeal consumption is from the aquaculture industry. Elevated sea surface temperatures during summer 2024, caused by the meandering of the *Kuroshio* Current, severely damaged aquaculture production. Stocked fish, especially yellowtail and silver salmon, suffered losses in the pens, and the resulting fish feed consumption declined from the beginning of CY 2025.

The most popular aquaculture fish in Japan is yellowtail (*Seriola quinqueradiata*), also known as *buri* or *hamachi*. Furthermore, MAFF targets yellowtail as one of Japan's key exportable food items. Aquafarmers catch wild, juvenile yellowtail (about 5–10 cm, called *mojako*) in spring and raise them in net pens in southern Japan, such as Kagoshima Bay, for 1.5 to 3 years before shipment. Juvenile yellowtail require about 70–80 percent fishmeal in their compound feed, while adult yellowtail require about 30–45 percent fishmeal. In summer 2025, the juvenile yellowtail stocked in pens grew at a good rate as sea surface temperatures remained at acceptable levels. Other aquaculture species followed a similar pattern, returning fish feed demand to typical levels by the end of CY 2025. Assuming no similar heat damage in the near term, FAS/Tokyo forecasts that fish feed demand will recover over the next two years.

Japanese eel farmers faced an existential risk in 2025 when European Union (EU) countries proposed listing all eel species, including Japanese eel (*Anguilla japonica*), on the Convention on International Trade in Endangered Species of Wild Fauna and Flora (CITES) Appendix II. The proposal was rejected in November 2025, and Japanese eel producers appear able to continue operations. Compound feed for eel requires about 70 percent fishmeal, and eels prefer a mix of approximately 50 percent brown fishmeal (derived from sardine or anchovy) and 50 percent white fishmeal (fishmeal derived from Alaskan pollock).

Other major aquaculture species, such as sea bream and silver salmon, usually require a lower percentage of fishmeal in their compound feed (20–30 percent). The Japanese aquaculture sector has worked to reduce fishmeal inclusion rates in compound feed to lower production costs. However,

aquaculture species are heterogeneous, and each requires a different nutritional profile. Unlike livestock production, fishmeal remains essential for Japanese aquaculture.

Palm Kernel Meal

FAS/Tokyo anticipates that palm kernel meal (PKM) feed consumption will continue at approximately 4,000 MT per year. Industry sources indicate that PKM in Japan has very limited use and is considered an extremely minor niche feed ingredient for ruminant animals, such as sheep.

Food Use Consumption

FAS/Tokyo projects that food-use soybean meal consumption in Japan will remain stable at 200,000 MT for both MY 2025/26 and MY 2026/27.

Soy sauce, isolated plant protein products (such as alternative meats), hydrolyzed vegetable protein (HVP), and beer-like alcoholic beverages are mainly produced from imported, defatted soy flour made from food-grade special soybean varieties (i.e., food-grade soybean meal). Japanese soy protein manufacturers mainly use U.S. IP food-grade soybean meal, while soy sauce manufacturers use Indian, U.S., and Japanese food-grade soybean meal. For further information on the Japanese soy food industry, please see [JA2021-0040](#).

Soy isolates are often used to improve the texture for meat products and to enhance moisture retention in processed foods. Under the current inflationary environment, Japanese food manufacturers have tried to control production costs, prompting many companies to increase the ratio of soy isolates to replace more expensive ingredients such as meat and fish. At the same time, the market for plant-based meat alternative products, which expanded rapidly before and during the COVID pandemic has since leveled off. Consequently, FAS/Tokyo forecasts stable soybean meal use for food in the near term. For additional information on plant-based meat alternatives, see [JA2023-0061](#).

Industrial Consumption

FAS/Tokyo anticipates there will be stable industrial (fertilizer) usage of soybean and rapeseed meals at 200,000 MT and 100,000 MT, respectively, in MY 2025/26 and MY 2026/27. Fishmeal use for fertilizer is expected to decline to 43,000 MT in CY 2026 and CY 2027 due to prohibitively high costs.

The primary industrial users of soybean meal, rapeseed meal, and fishmeal are specialty crop growers, such as tea and tobacco farmers. In Japan, reliable fertilizer input data are not published, but industry experts suggest that demand for these meals remains low because chemical fertilizers dominate the market.

Palm Kernel Shell

Palm kernel meal (PKM) for industrial purposes is not used in Japan. However, Japan relies heavily on palm kernel shells (PKS) and other oil palm–derived residues, such as empty fruit bunches, as biomass fuel for power generation (see [Japan Biomass Annual](#)). Feed-in-tariff (FIT) eligible medium- to large-scale biomass power plants use PKS and imported wood pellets as stable feedstocks. The usage in biomass power plants has driven PKS imports upward since 2012.

The Ministry of Economy, Trade and Industry (METI) began requiring stricter third-party environmental certification for PKS from April 2024 to establish eligibility under the FIT program. Despite initial industry concerns, PKS consumption has remained strong because Japanese importers have successfully secured certified PKS. In 2024/25, Japan's PKS consumption from Indonesia, Malaysia, and Thailand increased to 6.9 MMT; however, it is critical to emphasize that PKS is not PKM. PKS consumption for power generation is expected to continue a steady rise in MY 2025/26 and MY 2026/27.

Trade

Japan has no tariff on meal products.

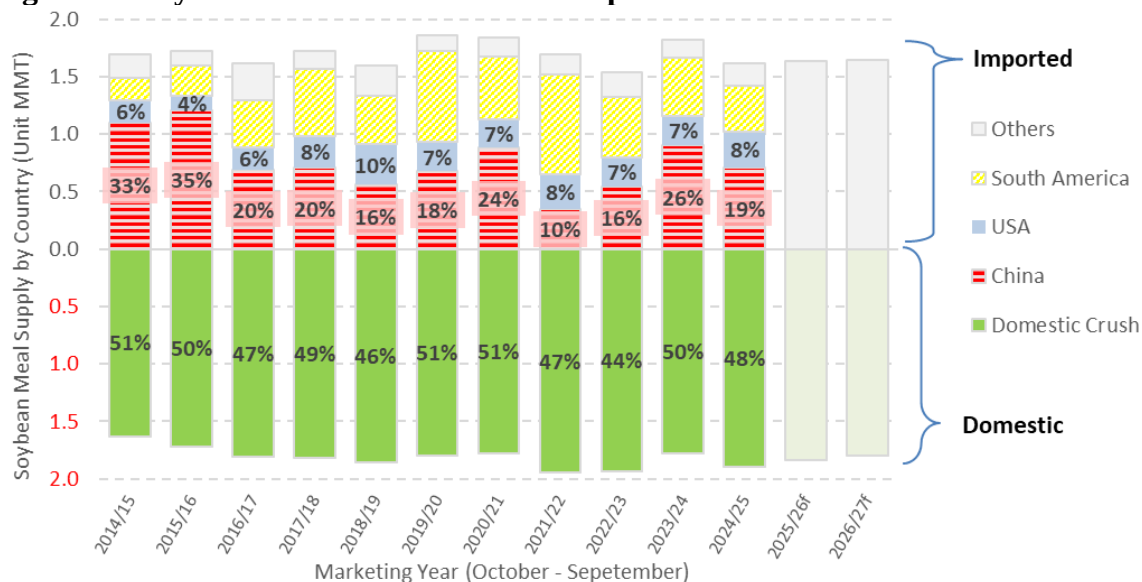
Rapeseed Meal

FAS/Tokyo forecasts fertilizer-grade rapeseed meal imports to remain around 5,000 MT annually over the coming years. According to Japan Customs, in MY 2024/25 Japanese imports of fertilizer-grade high-erucic acid, rapeseed meal from China and India declined to 4,202 MT, a 23 percent decrease from MY 2023/24. Japan does not import rapeseed meal for feed.

Soybean Meal

FAS/Tokyo forecasts that Japan's soybean meal imports will marginally increase to 1.66 MMT in MY 2025/26 and to 1.70 MMT in MY 2026/27. Domestic soybean meal production will decline, and Japan will seek to increase soybean meal imports to meet protein demand from the livestock sector. As of spring 2026, soybean meal is relatively inexpensive and abundantly available.

Figure 10. Soybean Meal Market Share in Japan



Source: MAFF, Japan Customs

In MY 2024/25, Japan Customs reported that Japanese soybean meal imports decreased to 1.62 MMT, an 11.0 percent decline from MY 2023/24. Japan increased soybean crush in MY 2024/25 and was able to reduce soybean meal imports. In MY 2024/25, China was the primary supplier with a 43.9 percent market share, followed by Brazil with 25.0 percent and the United States with 18.9 percent.

Japanese oil crushers are concentrated along the Pacific Belt and usually deliver soybean meal to nearby feed millers to minimize transportation costs. Feed millers located far from crushers generally rely on imported soybean meal. Hi-Pro soybean meal is often sourced from Brazil and China, while the United States supplies Lo-Pro soybean meal mainly to Hokkaido. Japanese feed manufacturers prefer to import from Asian countries in container shipments to enable just-in-time delivery. Imported soybean meal constitutes roughly half of Japan's soybean meal supply (Figure 10). Furthermore, given that Japanese consumers regularly eat raw eggs, feed millers often request salmonella-free soybean meal.

In addition to feed-use soybean meal, Japan imports non-GE soybean meal from the United States and India destined for the food manufacturing sector.

Palm Kernel Meal (PKM) and Palm Kernel Shells (PKS)

FAS/Tokyo anticipates that Japanese imports of PKS, which are often incorrectly recorded as PKM from Malaysia, will remain around 75,000 MT over the next two marketing years. Japan imports PKS and other oil palm derived by-products from Indonesia, Malaysia, and Thailand for power generation, leveraging the feed-in tariff (FIT) scheme. In MY 2024/25, Malaysia exported 77,445 MT of HS 2306.60 products to Japan, a 41.5 percent decrease from the previous MY. Malaysian exporters frequently choose between HS 2306.60 and HS 1404.90 for PKS. In MY 2024/25, more exporters correctly used HS 1404.90. Since the vast majority of Japan's HS 2306.60 import statistics are actually PKS, FAS/Tokyo relies on Malaysian export statistics to complete the Production, Supply, and Distribution (PSD) table (see the estimation methodology in [JA2020-0110](#)). For more detailed information on the Japanese PKS market for power generation, see the [Japan Biomass Annual](#).

Fishmeal

FAS/Tokyo forecasts that Japan will need to increase fishmeal imports to 155,000 MT in CY 2026 and 158,000 MT in CY 2027 to offset declining domestic production and meet recovering feed demand from the aquaculture sector.

Traditionally, Japan has mainly procured "brown meal" derived from Peruvian *anchoveta* (*Engraulis ringens*) from Peru, Chile, and Ecuador for general aquaculture and poultry diets, and "white meal" derived from Alaskan pollock for eel farming and piglet feed. However, over the past 15 years, Japan has increasingly imported lower-cost fishmeal produced from trimmings and white fish, such as Pangasius and golden threadfin bream, from a more diversified group of suppliers in Southeast Asia, South Asia, and the Middle East.

According to Japan Customs, in CY 2025 (FM-MY 2024/25) Japan imported 171,053 MT of fishmeal (see Table 3) from various countries. Peru was the leading supplier with a 24.1 percent import share, and the United States was the second largest supplier with a 12.3 percent share. Japan additionally imported 5,584 MT of krill and other crustacean meal used to stimulate feed intake and enhance flesh coloration for fish (these values are excluded from the PSD table).

Japan exported 6,856 MT of fishmeal and 1,640 MT of crustacean meal in CY 2025, with the vast majority shipped to Taiwan. Because the New Taiwan dollar has remained strong relative to the Japanese yen, Japan is expected to continue selling fishmeal to Taiwan over the next two marketing years.

Stocks

FAS/Tokyo forecasts that soybean meal stocks will remain steady at around 120,000 MT in both MY 2025/26 and MY 2026/27, as oil crushers maintain production levels. In contrast, rapeseed meal ending stocks are projected to increase to 95,000 MT in MY 2025/26 and to 100,000 MT in MY 2026/27, as oil crushers require more time to sell off the increased production amounts. FAS/Tokyo also forecasts that fishmeal stocks will marginally decline to around 15,000 MT in the next two FM-MYs as domestic fishmeal production falls.

In MY 2024/25, [MAFF](#) reported soybean meal beginning stocks (end of September 2023) at 123,373 MT (72,042 MT held by crushers and 51,331 MT held by feed millers) and ending stocks (end of September 2024) at 118,719 MT (65,496 MT at crushers and 53,223 MT at feed millers). MAFF also reported rapeseed meal beginning stocks at 83,081 MT (62,905 MT at crushers and 20,176 MT at feed millers) and ending stocks at 88,734 MT (69,004 MT at crushers and 19,730 MT at feed millers).

According to [MAFF](#), feed manufacturers held 23,921 MT of fishmeal at the beginning of FM-MY 2024/25 (end of December 2024) and reduced stocks to 15,896 MT at the beginning of FM-MY 2025/26 (end of December 2025).

Oils

Commodities:

Oil, Soybean

Oil, Rapeseed

Oil, Palm

Oil, Sunflower seed

Production, Supply, and Distribution of Soybean Oil

Oil, Soybean Market Year Begins Japan	MY 2024/2025		MY 2025/2026		MY 2026/2027	
	Oct 2024		Oct 2025		Oct 2026	
	USDA Official	New Post	USDA Official	New Post	USDA Official	New Post
Crush (1000 MT)	2,485	2,512	2,350	2,450	0	2,400
Extr. Rate, 999.9999 (PERCENT)	0.200	0.202	0.205	0.200	0	0.200
Beginning Stocks (1000 MT)	21	21	20	17	0	20
Production (1000 MT)	497	507	481	490	0	480
MY Imports (1000 MT)	1	1	2	2	0	2
Total Supply (1000 MT)	519	529	503	509	0	502
MY Exports (1000 MT)	0	1	1	1	0	1
Industrial Dom. Cons. (1000 MT)	35	45	40	40	0	40
Food Use Dom. Cons. (1000 MT)	464	466	435	448	0	441
Feed Waste Dom. Cons. (1000 MT)	0	0	0	0	0	0
Total Dom. Cons. (1000 MT)	499	511	475	488	0	481
Ending Stocks (1000 MT)	20	17	27	20	0	20
Total Distribution (1000 MT)	519	529	503	509	0	502
(1000 MT), (PERCENT)						
OFFICIAL DATA CAN BE ACCESSED AT: PSD Online Advanced Query						

Production, Supply, and Distribution of Rapeseed Oil

Oil, Rapeseed Market Year Begins Japan	MY 2024/2025		MY 2025/2026		MY 2026/2027	
	Oct 2024		Oct 2025		Oct 2026	
	USDA Official	New Post	USDA Official	New Post	USDA Official	New Post
Crush (1000 MT)	2,150	2,129	2,370	2,150	0	2,150
Extr. Rate, 999.9999 (PERCENT)	0.430	0.415	0.430	0.420	0	0.420
Beginning Stocks (1000 MT)	30	30	38	30	0	30
Production (1000 MT)	925	884	1020	903	0	903
MY Imports (1000 MT)	23	23	15	15	0	15
Total Supply (1000 MT)	978	937	1073	948	0	948
MY Exports (1000 MT)	5	5	5	5	0	5
Industrial Dom. Cons. (1000 MT)	55	50	55	50	0	50
Food Use Dom. Cons. (1000 MT)	880	852	975	863	0	863
Feed Waste Dom. Cons. (1000 MT)	0	0	0	0	0	0
Total Dom. Cons. (1000 MT)	935	902	1030	913	0	913
Ending Stocks (1000 MT)	38	30	38	30	0	30
Total Distribution (1000 MT)	978	937	1073	948	0	948
(1000 MT), (PERCENT)						
OFFICIAL DATA CAN BE ACCESSED AT: PSD Online Advanced Query						

Production, Supply, and Distribution of Palm Oil

Oil, Palm	MY 2024/2025		MY 2025/2026		MY 2026/2027	
Market Year Begins	Oct 2024		Oct 2025		Oct 2026	
Japan	USDA Official	New Post	USDA Official	New Post	USDA Official	New Post
Area Planted (1000 HA)	0	0	0	0	0	0
Beginning Stocks (1000 MT)	8	8	16	9	0	10
Production (1000 MT)	0	0	0	0	0	0
MY Imports (1000 MT)	653	653	650	660	0	660
Total Supply (1000 MT)	661	661	666	669	0	670
MY Exports (1000 MT)	0	0	0	0	0	0
Industrial Dom. Cons. (1000 MT)	110	94	110	96	0	97
Food Use Dom. Cons. (1000 MT)	535	555	520	560	0	560
Feed Waste Dom. Cons. (1000 MT)	0	3	0	3	0	3
Total Dom. Cons. (1000 MT)	645	652	630	659	0	660
Ending Stocks (1000 MT)	16	9	36	10	0	10
Total Distribution (1000 MT)	661	661	666	669	0	670
(1000 HA), (1000 TREES), (1000 MT), (MT/HA)						
OFFICIAL DATA CAN BE ACCESSED AT: PSD Online Advanced Query						

Production, Supply, and Distribution of Sunflower Seed Oil

Oil, Sunflowerseed	2024/2025		2025/2026		2026/2027	
Market Year Begins	Oct 2024		Oct 2025		Oct 2026	
Japan	USDA Official	New Post	USDA Official	New Post	USDA Official	New Post
Crush (1000 MT)	0	0	0	0	0	0
Extr. Rate, 999.9999 (PERCENT)	0	0	0	0	0	0
Beginning Stocks (1000 MT)	4	4	2	1	0	1
Production (1000 MT)	0	0	0	0	0	0
MY Imports (1000 MT)	18	16	15	20	0	22
Total Supply (1000 MT)	22	20	17	21	0	23
MY Exports (1000 MT)	0	0	0	0	0	0
Industrial Dom. Cons. (1000 MT)	2	2	2	3	0	4
Food Use Dom. Cons. (1000 MT)	18	17	13	17	0	18
Feed Waste Dom. Cons. (1000 MT)	0	0	0	0	0	0
Total Dom. Cons. (1000 MT)	20	19	15	20	0	22
Ending Stocks (1000 MT)	2	1	2	1	0	1
Total Distribution (1000 MT)	22	20	17	21	0	23
(1000 MT), (PERCENT)						
OFFICIAL DATA CAN BE ACCESSED AT: PSD Online Advanced Query						

Note: Sunflower seed oil PSD figures do not include safflower seed oil.

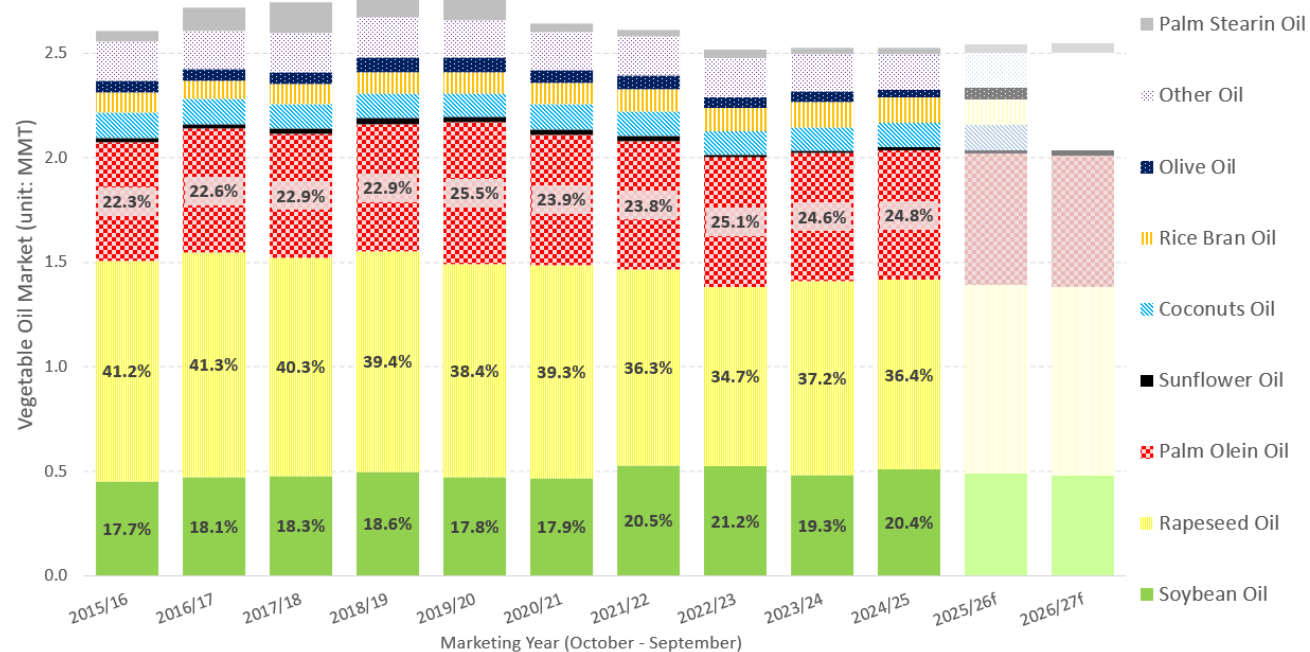
Overall Vegetable Oil Market

Japanese vegetable oil demand remains the primary driver of the country's oilseeds and products market. FAS/Tokyo projects that vegetable oil consumption will remain flat at approximately 2.5 MMT over the next two market years, as consumer demand stagnates and tourist numbers plateau.

Japan's vegetable oil supply totaled 2.53 MMT in MY 2023/24, unchanged from the previous MY. As seen in Figure 11, rapeseed oil remained the most supplied vegetable oil, accounting for 36.4 percent of total edible oil supply, though its share declined slightly. In contrast, the shares of palm olein oil and soybean oil increased to 24.8 percent and 20.4 percent, respectively. Rice bran oil, leveraging domestic rice bran, continued to gain popularity among Japanese households, increasing its share to 4.9 percent. Coconut oil supply rose marginally to 4.7 percent, driven by a shortage of solid fats. Corn oil and

sesame oil, both predominantly crushed domestically from imported ingredients, accounted for 2.9 percent and 2.3 percent of the market, respectively. The historically low olive crop yield in Europe led to higher wholesale prices for olive oil, resulting in a reduced market share of just 1.5 percent. However, olive oil imports to Japan have shown some recovery as of spring 2026. Sunflower seed oil imports have also rebounded, with a slight increase in market share to 0.6 percent. Cotton seed oil continues to occupy a niche position, maintaining a minimal market share of 0.2 percent.

Figure 11. Japanese Vegetable Oil Production and Imports



Sources: MAFF and Japan Customs

Note: Until MY 2019/20, Japan utilized imported palm stearin oil as energy feedstock and thus FAS/Tokyo omitted palm stearin oil from its calculation of the total “edible” vegetable oil consumption. The MY 2025/26 forecast includes actual data from October 2025 to January 2026.

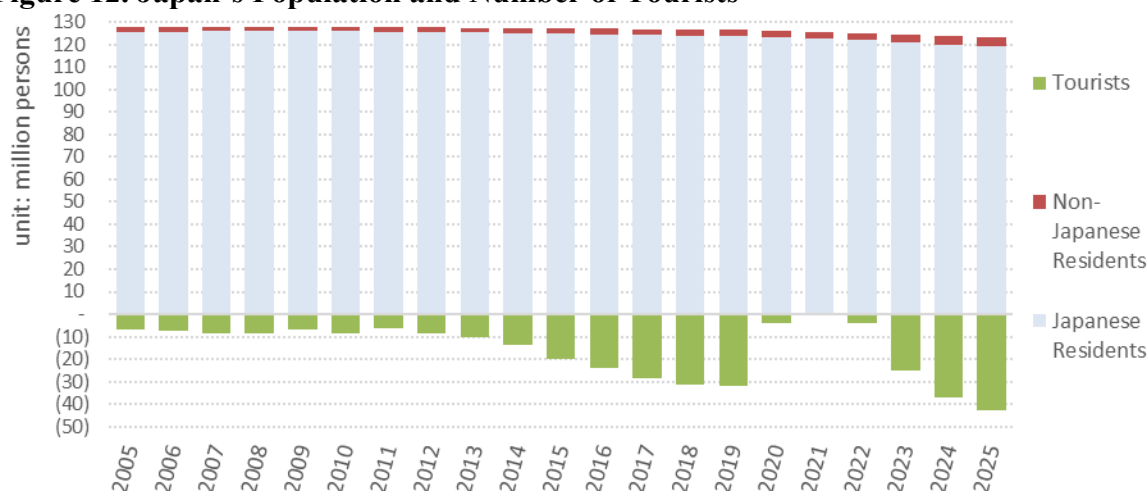
Major Japanese crushers continue to face rising energy, labor, and transportation costs, compounded by a weakened yen and declining meal prices. Higher prices for food, energy, and imported goods—driven by a weaker yen and global commodity trends—have eroded the purchasing power of ordinary Japanese households. Although Japan’s inflation rate since 2022 was generally lower than that of many Western countries, particularly the United States, it exceeds historical averages, making consumers more price sensitive. Japan’s core consumer price index (excluding fresh food and energy) hovered between 2.5 and 3.4 percent in 2025.

In response, businesses and households are actively seeking ways to reduce consumption. Restaurants have invested in oil filters and long-life oil products to minimize usage, while the baking and snack industries have adopted “shrinkflation,” offering smaller-sized products to maintain profit margins. Overproduction of vegetable oils under these conditions has led to retail price discounting, which puts profits at risk. As a mitigation measure, Japanese crushers are strategically controlling the production volumes for soybean and canola oil.

As of [October 2025](#), Japan’s population stood at 122.9 million, a decline of 4 percent from the 2008 peak. However, the number of non-Japanese residents reached a record high of 3.84 million, accounting for over 3 percent of the total population (see Figure 12). Additionally, the weak yen also was a key factor for the record-breaking 42.7 million international visitors in 2025, a 15 percent increase over 2024 (see Figure 12). These foreign visitors and non-Japanese residents help offset shrinking domestic vegetable oil demand and create new market opportunities.

Following November 2025, politically motivated safety warnings from the Chinese government to their citizens to avoid traveling to Japan, the number of Chinese tourists has dropped significantly. If Japan and China do not reach a resolution, tourist numbers are expected to continue the decline in 2026.

Figure 12. Japan’s Population and Number of Tourists



Source: [MIC](#), [JNTO](#)

Three major uncertainties could impact vegetable oil demand forecasts in next two MYs. These factors are considered uncertainties and are not included in FAS/Tokyo’s demand forecasts.

1. **Chinese Tourism:** A political solution between Japan and China could boost vegetable oil demand through increased tourism.
2. **Consumption Tax Suspension:** The Takaichi Administration has announced discussions to suspend the 8 percent consumption tax on grocery food items for two years. Eliminating this tax on vegetable oils and related products would positively impact oilseed demand.
3. **Exchange Rates and Commodity Prices:** Japan relies on imports for about 90 percent of its energy and 60 percent of its food (calorie base). A weak yen translates into higher grocery prices, including vegetable oil. Although the yen remains at its weakest level since the Plaza Accords in 1985, the Takaichi Administration abolished provisional gasoline and diesel taxes in December 2025 ([JA2025-0063](#)), stabilizing consumer prices in the beginning of 2026. However, further yen depreciation and rising global commodity prices resulting from geopolitical events could negatively impact vegetable oil consumption.

For more detailed insights into the situation of Japan’s retail foods, food service sectors, and food processing ingredients, please refer to [JA2025-0068](#) (food service), [JA2025-0048](#) (retail foods), and [JA2025-0014](#) (food processing ingredients).

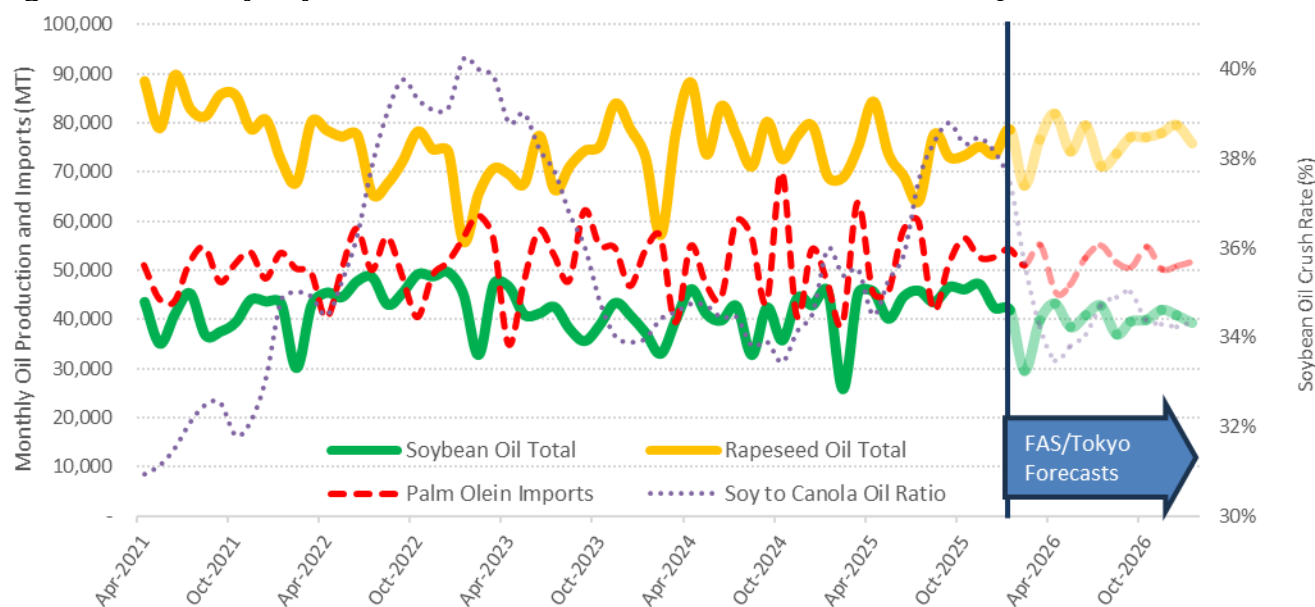
Production

Soybean and Rapeseed Oil

For MY 2025/26, FAS/Tokyo forecasts that Japanese oil crushers will reduce soybean oil production to 0.490 MMT, representing a 3.4 percent decrease from the previous year. This decline is attributed to deteriorating crush margins for soybeans and continuing weak consumer demand for vegetable oil. The extraction rate for soybean oil is projected at 0.200. In contrast, rapeseed oil production is expected to rise to 0.903 MMT, a 2.1 percent increase from the previous MY, with a marginally higher extraction rate of 0.420. Assuming the current market conditions unchanged, FAS/Tokyo anticipates soybean oil production will decline to 0.480 MMT, while canola (rapeseed) oil production will remain steady at 0.903 MMT in MY 2026/27 (see Table 1 in “Oilseeds” section).

At the start of MY 2025/26, oil production was robust, supported by stable global commodity prices and a relatively steady Japanese yen, which hovered around 140 yen to the U.S. dollar. Supermarkets occasionally discounted vegetable oil products to attract consumers. However, by the end of 2025, the situation shifted abruptly. Subsequently, the Japanese yen depreciated to approximately 160 yen per U.S. dollar as long-term bond yields rose, a market reaction to the Takaichi Administration’s fiscal policies.

Figure 13. Monthly Soybean and Canola Oil Production and Palm Oil Imports



Source: [MAFF](#), Japan Customs

In response to rising costs, major producers such as Nisshin Oillio and J Oil Mills announced price increases of 7 to 14 percent for their oil products effective April 1, 2026. [J Oil Mills](#) noted that current price levels do not fully reflect increased costs, citing recent rises in raw material prices for soybeans and rapeseed. These increases are driven by the expectation of increased purchases of U.S. soybeans by China, in addition to the resumption of Canadian rapeseed imports. Additionally, anticipation of new U.S. Environmental Protection Agency biofuel blending mandates has pushed soybean oil values higher, while meal values have declined, further challenging crushing margins. The company also highlighted the heightened geopolitical risks following the U.S. and Israeli attack on Iran on February 28, 2026,

which has contributed to increased volatility in global commodity markets, including crude oil and oilseeds. As a result, further price adjustments may be necessary, and the consumption of canola and soybean oil is expected to slow in the latter part of MY 2025/26.

Given these market dynamics, Japanese crushers are closely monitoring oilseed prices and remain prepared to adjust procurement strategies as needed. In MY 2024/25, favorable soybean oil margins led to a production increase to 507,113 MT, a 5.9 percent rise from the previous year. Conversely, canola oil production declined to 884,355 MT, a 3.9 percent decrease. As crush margins for canola oil improved relative to soybean oil at the start of MY 2025/26, crushers are expected to shift toward increasing canola processing over soybean processing from mid-MY 2025/26 onward (Figure 13).

Palm Oil and Sunflower Seed Oil

Japan does not crush palm or sunflower seeds.

Consumption

Food Use

FAS/Tokyo forecasts that the food-use consumption of soybean oil will decrease gradually to 0.448 MMT in MY 2025/26 and to 0.441 MMT in MY 2026/27, as Japanese increase canola oil consumption. As such, food-use consumption of canola oil is projected to rise modestly to 0.863 MMT in MY 2025/26 and MY 2026/27. Despite high oilseed costs and low meal values, domestically produced oils have remained relatively more affordable compared to imported alternatives, prompting food service operators to favor canola and soybean oils over palm oil for frying and other applications. Retail sales of table cooking oils to households remained stable through the end of MY 2024/25, as inflationary pressures eased. However, the renewed depreciation of the Japanese yen from fall 2025 has worsened the business environment for oil crushers, who have announced retail price increases for salad oil effective from April 2026. This is expected to dampen consumer demand. Given the more favorable crush margin for canola compared to soybeans, crushers are expected to increase the proportion of canola oil in blended cooking oil products.

FAS/Tokyo anticipates a gradual recovery in sunflower seed oil consumption for food-use, reaching to 17,000 MT in MY 2025/26 and 18,000 MT in MY 2026/27, contingent on Eastern European supply conditions. In Japan, high oleic sunflower oil is used in the production of cocoa butter equivalents via transesterification, a trend driven by surging cocoa bean prices. Sunflower oil is also utilized in margarine, salad dressings, and as a household cooking oil. For example, the Showa Sangyo company markets olein-rich sunflower oil in retail bottles. Imports from Turkey and Spain are available in ethnic grocery stores, catering to Japan's growing South Asian resident population, which has quadrupled over the past decade and has a preference for sunflower oil for cooking.

FAS/Tokyo projects that food-use consumption of palm oil will stay at 0.56 MMT in MY 2025/26 and MY 2026/27. Three factors supported palm oil demand in MY 2024/25: 1) robust production of instant noodles and frozen foods⁵ (which require palm oil for its heat stability and shelf life); 2) a shortage of animal fats (notably lard); and 3) the need for cocoa butter equivalents amid high cocoa bean prices. However, as palm oil prices remain elevated relative to canola and soybean oil, food service operators

⁵ [JA2025-0031](#) explains Japan's frozen food industry.

are continuing to favor the latter for frying applications. As a result, palm oil demand is expected to remain robust and consistent but also constrained by price competitiveness.

Industrial Use

Vegetable oils are increasingly used in industrial sectors and oleochemical applications, including lubricants, toiletries, and paints. As of MY 2025/26, Japan does not utilize new vegetable oils for biofuel production.

Soybean, Canola, and Sunflower Seed Oil

FAS/Tokyo forecasts that industrial consumption of soybean oil will stay around approximately 40,000 MT in MY 2025/26 and MY 2026/27. Epoxidized soybean oil is used as a plasticizer and stabilizer in polyvinyl chloride (PVC) plastics and food wraps, while soy ink and natural esters represent additional industrial applications.

The industrial consumption of canola oil is projected to remain stable at 50,000 MT for MY 2025/26 and MY 2026/27, with uses in chemical manufacturing, paint production, cosmetics, and pharmaceuticals. Sunflower seed oil for industrial use will gradually increase to 3,000 MT in MY 2025/26 and 4,000 MT in MY 2026/27. Sunflower seed oil is used in cosmetics and other industrial applications, but supply disruptions due to the Russia-Ukraine conflict have led Japanese users to seek alternative oils. Some imports from Europe and Turkey are used as carrier oils for therapeutic purposes.

Palm Oil

FAS/Tokyo projects that the total industrial use of palm oil will remain around 96,000-97,000 MT over the next two marketing years. Palm oil is primarily used in toiletries, pharmaceuticals, and lubricants. Palm stearin, a non-edible byproduct of palm olein production, was previously used as a bioenergy feedstock, but current prices render this application unprofitable under the fixed Feed-in Tariff (FIT) scheme.

As of March 2026, Japanese companies have not adopted new vegetable oils as feedstock for biodiesel or sustainable aviation fuel (SAF) production. Biodiesel output remains minimal, relying mainly on limited supplies of used cooking oil (UCO). Notably, Cosmo Energy has begun producing hydrotreated esters and fatty acids (HEFA) SAF from locally sourced UCO in *Sakai City*, Osaka, with an annual capacity of 30 million liters.

Japan generates approximately 500,000 MT of UCO annually, with 180,000 MT used for animal feed, 110,000 MT exported (mainly for SAF and biodiesel production), 50,000 MT used in chemical manufacturing, and about 20,000 MT allocated for biodiesel feedstock. For further details, see the [Japan 2025 Biofuels Annual](#).

Feed Use

FAS/Tokyo forecasts that Japan will use 3,000 MT of palm oil for feed in MY 2025/26 and MY 2026/27, in response to UCO shortages.

Feed millers require approximately 380,000 MT of fats and oils for compound feed production, but domestic UCO supplies only satisfy 180,000 MT of this demand. Consequently, Japanese feed

manufacturers must procure about 200,000 MT of vegetable oils and animal fats annually, including around 3,000 MT of palm oil for feed use.

Trade

Tariff Environment

Historically, tariffs on vegetable oil products protected Japanese oilseed crushers. However, the Comprehensive and Progressive Agreement for Trans-Pacific Partnership (CPTPP) and the Japan-EU Economic Partnership Agreement (EPA) have eliminated Japan's tariffs on soybean oil, rapeseed oil, and sunflower seed oil. The U.S.-Japan Trade Agreement (USJTA) removed import duties on crude vegetable oil products in line with CPTPP, but USJTA does not cover many refined vegetable oil products included under CPTPP. Most of Japan's imports of palm oil, coconut oil, palm kernel oil, and olive oil enter tariff-free due to bilateral EPAs with exporting countries. For further details on tariff treatment of vegetable oils under USJTA, see [USJTA Tariff Information](#).

Soybean Oil

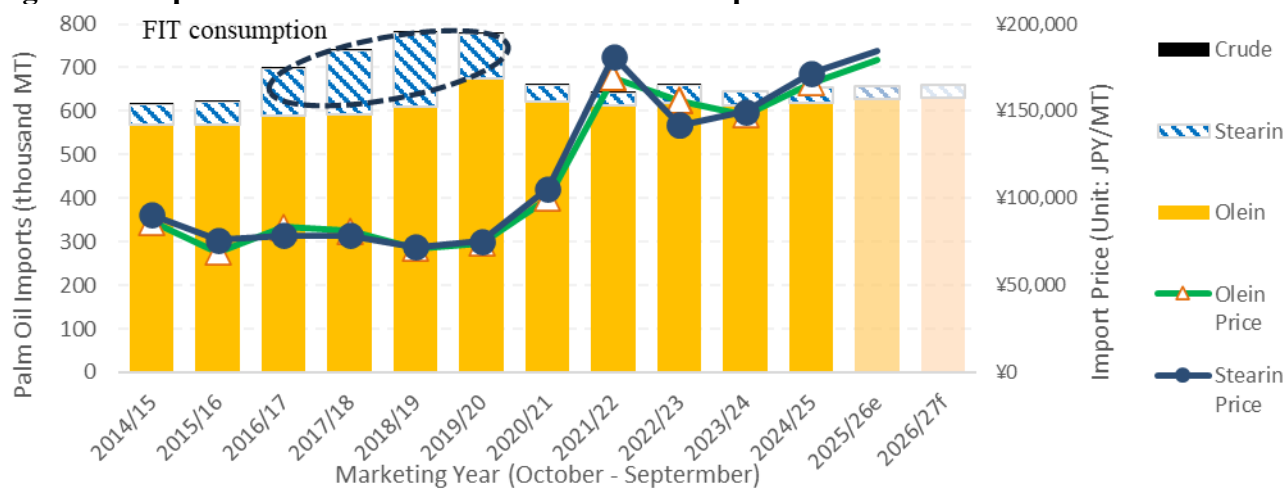
FAS/Tokyo projects soybean oil imports will remain at 2,000 MT in MY 2025/26 and MY 2026/27. Imported soybean oil constitutes a very small share of Japan's total soybean oil supply. In MY 2023/24, Japan imported only 1,467 MT of soybean oil, primarily refined products from Taiwan and South Korea. Discount supermarket chains and ethnic stores directly import and sell these oils to price-sensitive consumers. Additionally, some U.S. companies export specially processed soybean oil for industrial applications.

Rapeseed Oil

With a strong domestic canola crush anticipated, FAS/Tokyo forecasts rapeseed oil imports will decline to approximately 15,000 MT in MY 2025/26 and MY 2026/27. Japan also resumed the imports of crude canola oil from Australia and Canada in spring 2025. In MY 2024/25, Japanese rapeseed oil imports rose sharply to 22,639 MT, up from a historical low of 7,988 MT in MY 2023/24.

Palm Oil

Figure 14. Japan's Annual Palm Olein and Stearin Imports



Source: Japan Customs

Note: "e" indicates year-to-date estimation from October 2025 to January 2026.

Despite high palm oil prices, FAS/Tokyo projects palm oil imports will increase to 0.660 MMT in MY 2025/26 and MY 2026/27. In MY 2024/25, Japan imported 652,840 MT of palm olein and stearin, a 1.3 percent increase from the previous MY (Figure 14). Malaysia accounted for 86.7 percent of import share, with Indonesia supplying 13.2 percent. Under the ASEAN-Japan Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement, Japan imposes no duty on palm oil from ASEAN member countries. Even if one were to add an export tax, Indonesian palm oil would remain more affordable than the Malaysian product, but all things considered Japanese importers tend to prefer importing palm oil from Malaysia. Importantly, obtaining certification is critical for Japanese large users.

Sunflower Seed Oil

FAS/Tokyo anticipates Japanese imports of sunflower seed oil will gradually recover to 20,000 MT in MY 2025/26 and 22,000 MT in MY 2026/27. Japan's ideal annual import volume is around 25,000 MT, but imports have been disrupted following Russia's February 2022 invasion of Ukraine. In MY 2024/25, imports increased to 15,578 MT (Table 5). For commercial use, crude sunflower oil was sourced from Hungary, Argentina, and Ukraine, and refined domestically for bottled salad oil, margarine, cocoa butter equivalents, and other products.

Refined sunflower seed oils are imported directly for retail sale. High-end, cold-pressed sunflower oil is imported from France, Italy, and other European countries, while economical sunflower oil sourced from Turkey and Spain is used for cooking. Under the Japan-EU EPA, EU sunflower seed oil enters Japan tariff free.

Table 5. Sunflower and Safflower Seed Oil Imports to Japan

	2020/21	2021/22	2022/23	2023/24	2024/25
Total Sunflower Seed Oil	26,484	24,040	10,707	12,151	15,578
Crude Sunflower Oil (0.6<AV)	19,687	15,736	3,280	4,032	7,953
from Hungary	1,690	2,940	2,458	3,549	2,790
from Argentina	4,831	194	0	0	2,271
from Ukraine	3,627	4,111	821	234	2,530
Crude Sunflower Oil (AV<0.6)	65	14	77	71	668
Refined Sunflower Oil	6,732	8,290	7,350	8,048	6,957
from Spain	3,161	4,507	3,000	2,265	3,539
from Turkey	1,667	2,094	2,067	3,688	2,225
from Italy	322	504	397	469	528
from Ukraine	88	89	123	160	300
Safflower Oil	5,148	4,068	3,509	2,722	2,214
from United States	1,785	3,335	2,551	1,934	1,153
from Mexico	3,322	611	956	766	1,059

Source: Japan Customs

Safflower Seed Oil

Separately, Japan imported 2,214 MT of safflower seed oil in MY 2024/25. The United States was the leading supplier with a 52 percent market share, followed by Mexico (Table 5). Safflower seed and sunflower seed oils share the same 6-digit HS codes (1512.11 and 1512.99). High-oleic safflower seed oil is consumed as a premium cooking oil and is often given as a gift during year-end and mid-summer *Chugen* festivals. In addition, linoleic-type safflower oil is used as a drying oil in paint production.

Under the USJTA, Japan allows the tariff free import of U.S. safflower crude oil that has an acidic value exceeding 0.6. Safflower seed oil is not included in PSD figures.

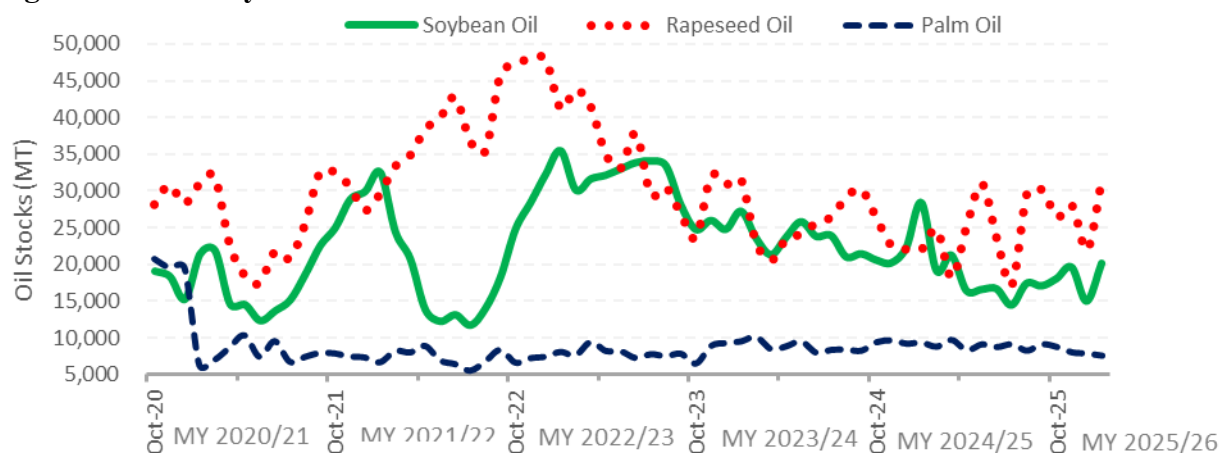
Stocks

FAS/Tokyo projects soybean oil stocks will remain stable at approximately 20,000 MT, while canola oil stocks are expected to hover around 30,000 MT as oil crushers continue to adjust inventory levels in response to market conditions. According to MAFF, soybean oil stocks declined to 17,088 MT at the start of MY 2025/26. For rapeseed oil, MAFF reported beginning stocks of 30,056 MT for MY 2025/26, unchanged from the previous marketing year (Figure 15).

Palm oil stocks have remained at exceedingly low levels since early 2021, as traders have consolidated inventories. MAFF reported palm oil stocks at 9,075 MT at the start of MY 2025/26. FAS/Tokyo projects palm oil stocks will remain around 10,000 MT through the end of MY 2026/27.

MAFF reported sunflower seed oil beginning stocks at 513 MT for MY 2024/25. Due to ongoing supply shortages, FAS/Tokyo forecasts sunflower seed oil stocks will remain below 1,000 MT for the next two marketing years.

Figure 15. Monthly Fluctuations in Crushers' Oil Stocks



Source: MAFF

Attachments:

No Attachments